



AND



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Sarvodaya Ideology & Acharya Vinoba Bhave

by

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*Amidst such an anomalous whirlpool of Action and Inter-action of the present-day world, there can be no other alternative which is so meaningful and substantial than the ideal of human unity, the doctrine of human good and the philosophy of world integration...Nevertheless, the ethno-centric attitudes based on ignoramus behaviours have created many a conflicting ideology between man and man, nation and nation, particularly in the recent past...How best can one unite Mankind on the principles of universal love and brotherhood has become the principal mission with the civilized man of today. Man as the main product of evolution has however taken the entire responsibility on himself to protect his species from being annihilated. A stage has come indeed, when the contemporary civilizations of the world have already begun to feel that without the element of Unification, the world is villainous, barren and bereft of any content. As such the purpose of the present **WORLD INTEGRATION SERIES** is mainly meant to promote human action based on altruistic standards as much as it is intended to protect the present progeny of Man, accelerate his progress and thereby save his destiny from being squandered, ruined and lost.—AUTHOR.*

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FOREWORD

Shri V. Narayan Karan Reddy, Lecturer in Philosophy, Osmania University has written an interesting brochure on "SARVODAYA IDEOLOGY & ACHARYA VINOBA BHAVE." Sarvodaya is a movement that has attracted world attention during recent years. Shri Vinoba Bhave has been acclaimed as a unique world personality. His movement for Science and Spirituality is a dynamic movement aiming at a complete transformation of the existing social order.

Shri V. N. K. Reddy has examined this movement in many of its significant aspects. As one who is well versed in Philosophy, he has quoted parallelisms in thought and action of movements and personalities in other ages and countries. Interesting material has been collected and grouped round each one of the aspects of Sarvodaya. The brochure is, thus, a source book for any one who wishes to study the essential cultural implications of Sarvodaya. The brochure makes stimulating reading.

I should be very glad if Shri Reddy writes more fully on the theme and gives an integrated portrait of the movement and its founder.

September, 1963.

V. K. GOKAK

Central Institute of English
Hyderabad.

INTRODUCTION

*Sri V. Narayan Karan Reddy presents in this small volume the quintessence of the philosophy of **Sarvodaya** in its various aspects ; and he deserves to be congratulated on the measure of success he has achieved.*

Sarvodaya is both a way of thought and a way of life. Mahatma Gandhi, the Father of the Nation, and his disciple, Acharya Vinoba Bhave, have given a new hope to humanity by recapturing the ancient principles of **Sarvodaya** and resetting them in the context of the modern world. As a way of thought, **Sarvodaya** exhorts man, not to think of himself in isolation from the rest of creation, but to feel convinced of his oneness with all. No individual can really rise on the depression of others. What every member of society should aim at is commonweal, the welfare of the whole, for all are aspects of one Reality, expressions of one Spirit. As a way of life, **Sarvodaya** stands for co-sharing and co-operation instead of mad race for accumulation through competition and aggression ; for peaceful and non violent progress instead of chaotic existence under the constant threat of dread and destruction. **Sarvodaya** is the gospel of wholeness ; and in this Space Age, there is no real alternative to it.

*Sri Reddy has argued ably the case for **Sarvodaya** with a wealth of comparative study, and with a historical perspective. I have great pleasure in commending his work.*
November, 1963.

Professor of Philosophy
University of Madras.

T. M. P. Mahadevan

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concept. Sarvodaya as an improvement over all forms of creative altruism, and evolutionary humanism. Marx aimed at material integration; Roussaeu opted for social integration; Buddha aspired for an ethical integration of mankind; Asoka endeavoured for moral integration and quite recently Sri Aurobindo inspiringly designed for a spiritual integration of mankind. Acharya Vinoba Bhave in the contemporary period is engaged in bringing about the *total human integration* from all angles and aspects of the present race of mankind.

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SARVODAYA IDEOLOGY AND ACHARYA VINOBA

Acharya Vinoba Bhave, the Walking Saint of India with his creative ideals of ever-growing Sarvodaya Samaj is fast tending to dominate the contemporary thought both social and moral.

Sarvodaya Ideology is considered as a creative blend of all humanistic and altruistic tendencies of the Age. It can however be interpreted in terms of an Integrated Social Philosophy in this age of Crisis.

Sarvodaya¹ is not a passive resistance to Evil as much as positive assimilation of Good. The Sarvodaya Ideology is a creative synthesis of individual happiness and social good. It is indeed considered as the integrated social philosophy² which redeems 'the reform of the individual as the reform of the society.'

1. 'Sarvodaya' is a pursuit after *Varnashrama-Dharmas*,¹ which cover all aspects of life. On the other hand *Abhyudaya* is a life after lower human ideals as rank and riches. The 'sarvodaya' way of life can be categorised further under those imperfect souls fully filled with aspiration i.e. *Sadhakas* and those perfect souls which are considered as the full fruits of real pursuit and absolute perfection i.e., *Siddhas*.

2. Sarvodaya as a synthetic philosophy of life includes in its scope all known philosophies both hu-

man and social. All other so-called absolute philosophies are one of its parts. They exist as infinitesimals. The summing-up of an infinite numbers of these infinitesimals is ordinarily viewed as practical aim of Sarvodaya. However, the true ideal of Sarvodaya is not mere summation or integration of the diverse virtues but their inherent application towards the service of man to become real man. All humanistic and altruistic tendencies are however related to Sarvodaya as much as parts are related to their wholes. The Sarvodaya integration is a dynamic process and so it consists in the development of more and more perfect forms. Care should be taken as to distinguish this integrated social philosophy from the integral spiritual philosophy of Sri Aurobindo which is based on his *Prapatti-Yoga*. Lat. Integrare=to make whole.

3. The ethical judgments are classed as judgments of value and judgments of obligation. The judgments of value are based on goodness or badness of an act; whereas the judgments of obligation are based on rightness or wrongness of the same. Both are treated as parallel theories in ethical philosophy. The former is interpreted as Axiology and the latter as Deontology. The same projected into social philosophies are called commonly as Utilitarianism and Intuitionism. Since the above theories are slightly divergent in their ethical view points, they have been long opposed to one another. Utilitarianism is a traditional view which believes in the principle of utility i.e., a right act is the act which produces the greatest amount of happiness in the world at large. However, Utilitarianism received its classical form in Bentham and two Mills. Earlier it took the theological form in Gay and Paley and later an evolutionistic form in Spencer and in the wider sense an intuitionistic form in Sidgwick. For the purposes of our academic interest, Utilitarianism can be discussed under Traditional Utilitarianism, i.e., which views

The Utilitarians³ led by Jeremy Bentham pleaded for 'the greatest good of the greatest numbers' in the past. The Sarvodaya seekers inspired by Acharya Vinoba Bhave tend to implore the good of all, the allay of all and ultimately welfare of all.

The insistence on individual purity which is an experience *Suigeneris* of an ideal Sarvodayi implies an immanent reform of the individual. Again, the existence of social appetite in Sarvodaya Ideology is indicative of a new social evolution in modern times. Thus, this contemporaneous process of individual reform and social good tend

pleasure as identical with good; the Ideal Utilitarianism i.e., which treats other things other than pleasure are also good and the American Utilitarianism reflected as it is through the pragmatic ethics of William James and John Dewy which views pleasure and good as those which benefit mankind. If we carefully analyse all the above forms of utilitarian ethics hitherto discussed and try to compare the same with the ethics of Sarvodaya, we discover a lot of divergence not only in their basic approaches but also in their practical application. Utilitarian ethics is at once egoistic and hedonistic; whereas the ethics of Sarvodaya is humanistic and altruistic.

4. Sarvodayi is not only the lover of all good but he is also the lover of all loveliness. A 'sarvodayi' runs after the subjective content of objective reality unlike an *adhikari* who weilds its objective worth. Again a 'sarvodayi' will never prefer, his self to others as much as a *vedantin*. A real *vedantin* is considered as *dharma-bhuta-Jnani* i.e., a person who commands a dual relationship to self i.e., *atman and God* i.e., *Paramatman*.

to evolve a new humanist philosophy hitherto unknown to human history.⁵

Albert Schweitzer⁶ the great altruist of the modern period advocated 'will-to-love' one and all in his philosophy of Universal benevolence. Acharya Vinoba Bhave, the Walking Saint of India preached 'will-to-do good' to all through his humanitarian ideals of Sarvodaya Philosophy. Acharya Bhave, like Albert Schweitzer very well believes in Life and World-affirmation. The egalitarian outlook of Acharya Vinoba Bhave and his deep faith in the oneness of Man and the ideal of Human Unity, draws him nearer to Albert Schweitzer's cardinal belief in 'Reverence for Life.' As Albert Schweitzer is considered by many as the moving and guiding spiritual force of the West,

5. Though Sarvodaya Ideology is universalistic in its ethical approach, its experience is alone of its kind. It is, however, based on enlightenment of the individual consciousness, evolution and propagation of social reform and the absolute feeling of God-realisation. Sarvodaya way of life is indeed atypical.

6. Albert Schweitzer was born at Kayserberg, France in a vintage year in an evangelical community in January 1875. The name Kayserberg derives from the great preacher Geiler-de-Kayserberg. The wisdom of Schweitzer has been communicated widely through his manifold mission as a Doctor, Colonist, as an Apostle, as a Theologian, as a philosopher much less as an Orator, Musician and as an Artist. Albert Schweitzer is one of the most challenging men of both wisdom and knowledge of the present world. Professor Langfeld, a Norwegian psychiatrist who made a close study of Dr. Schweitzer, once said that he always modelled himself on the lines of Jesus.

so Acharya Bhava is a living and inspiring symbol of the thirst-quenching wisdom of the East.

Sarvodaya Ideology is a dynamic energising force; it is a moral motivation within the individual and a social movement without the individual. The re-making of man by renovating his creative energies and re-creating his environment by re-shaping its rich resources form the dynamic ideals of Sarvodaya Samaj. However, a communitarian society striving for humanist civilization was the ideal with almost all the creative Prophets of the past. Acharya Vinoba Bhava⁷ is no exception to this. An ever-evolving individual being aspiring for an ever-growing social consciousness forms one of the most leading themes of Sarvodaya trend of thought.

Acharya Vinoba Bhava has decided to make his life fit his thoughts as Albert Schweitzer. While Albert Schweitzer is considered as the creative prophet of Altruism in the West, Acharya Vinoba Bhava can rightly be called as a creative Prophet of Humanism in the East. Modern

7. In each and every age, great men were considered as path-makers. They have been the torch-bearers of human communities throughout the world. However, the psychological ego of man is advanced towards the seers of the age for its proper fulfilment particularly in times of catastrophies small or big. The occasion has come for the people of India and the world to see towards spiritual prophets like Vinoba for help. It is in this anomalous whirl-pool of action and inter-action, the spiritual conscience of man springs into new dimensions. Whatsoever the wise man does in this world, other men try to do the same and whatever example a wise man sets in this world, all the rest try to follow...Vide Gita 3-(21).

civilization is ailing with all forms of physical, moral and spiritual injuries. Quite recently the psychical injuries crept-in causing a great menace to the self-regarding ideals of man. Against such a horrible back-ground, the two great living prophets of the world both Albert Schweitzer and Acharya Vinoba Bhave advocated the self-cultivation of certain human values which give man the desired courage and confidence to meet the ever-arising artificial challenges of society. The establishment of favourable conditions to one and all with the sole view of perfecting the individuals forms the basis of ethical thought with the the two eminent thinkers of the present Age. Both the Prophets affirm that internal progress of humanity invariably leads to its external progress. The essential spiritual advance of mankind is the real and ideal progress. Both Acharya Vinoba Bhave and Albert Schweitzer carry universal world-views with them. Again perpetual Peace is an ideal with both. The existence of order in the universe is very well preached by Schweitzer as much as Bhave, the author of the idea of Moral Universe in the recent past.

Count Leo Tolstoy⁸, who abandoned his normal career, impelled by his intense sincerity of thought wrote 'What

8. The Russian writer of wide eminence who lived mostly in the early part of the 19th century. He was a rich man and a heir to large Estates. His intense sincerity of thought impelled him to abandon his usual course of life. He arrived eventually at intellectual conclusions which involved non-resistance to evil, the abolition of Governments and nationality of Churches. He fondly believed in love of man and high faith in God. He was gifted with an amazing power which poured through his immortal works. His

then must we do' a deep study of economic conditions; in which he clearly represented the growing need for socio-economic equalities through peaceful revolution. Acharya Vinoba Bhave⁹ who initially preferred to lead a life of an ascetic inspired by Gandhian principles of living, set-out on a walking expedition of rural India. Throughout his travel, Acharya Vinoba Bhave kept the idea of Economics of the masses in the background of his mind. However, the ever-growing dynamic inter-action between his super-sensitive mind and the collective mind of the ever-aspiring masses rendered him with an irresistible confidence from occasion to occasion throughout his noble mission of Bhoodan.¹⁰ This aspect of his life can be viewed to a

voice spread far beyond Russia and very soon he became a prophet of the west. His deep moral conviction, his realistic details and his immense imaginative vision is similar to the gifted virtues of Acharya Vinoba Bhave. Of the many of his works 'War and Peace' is considered as his chief novel and 'What is Art' is treated as one of his best books.

9. Activism is never antagonistic to any forms of either altruism or spiritualism. Spiritual activity is the essence of reality particularly in India. However, the concept of pure act, i.e., *actus-purus* can be traced to Aristotle's Conception of Divinity.

10. Going back to the year 1951, that is, eleven years ago, when the people of Telangana, particularly those belonging to rural areas, were subjected to the violent disturbances caused by the Razakars and the counter-attacks effected by the communists, who had created ghastly scenes of wide-spread human destruction and who wanted to solve the land problem through violent means our Acharya Vinoba Bhave appeared on the scene. Like a great Saviour and one,

who is interested in peace and prosperity of the people, Vinobaji soon after finishing the Second Annual Sarvodaya Sammelan held at Shivrampalli set on a Peace Campaign to the East through hills and dales reached his third halt, Pochampalli, a remote village in Nalgonda district on 18th April 1951. At the outskirts of the village he was accorded a warm reception by the villagers and led through the village streets to the resting place near Harijanwada. When the people of the surrounding villages came to know earlier that "The Disciple of Gandhiji" is going to visit Pochampalli they thronged in huge numbers and took the holy *darshan* of the walking Saint. During his brief stay he began to enquire about the real cause of their discontent and their incessant need. Among others the Harijans of Pochampalli took their turn to take Vinoba's *darshan* and on the latter's initiative they told that they badly required land one acre each. That they comprised of eighty families and so they would be satisfied if they could get eighty acres. Turning round Vinoba asked the Village Patwari about the availability of any such Government land, whereon the reply came in the negative. On the same day in the evening soon after he finished his usual prayer meeting on a platform under a green wood tree he accosted the local landlords sitting nearby to give the required land to the poor as there was no Government land. Instantaneously I stood before Vinoba and offered one hundred acres of land on behalf of myself and my five brothers in memory of my dear deceased father towards the betterment of these poor harijan brethren and executed the required deed then and there only. Vinoba danced in ecstasy in the chorus of "Ram Dhun" of the local Bhajan Mandali. Thus the Bhoodan Movement took its birth in a remote village like this and very soon spread like a wild fire throughout the length and breadth of our great country. This Movement, ever since its inception is also

great extent along with the idealised picture of Moses¹¹ as related through the Talmudic legends who happen to have lead most heroically and successfully his followers to the destined goal of liberation. Acharya Vinoba Bhave is an ascetic by nature but his asceticism never kept him in mere isolation. On the other hand he moved courageously into the masses and could very well find a place in their hearts for generations to follow. As Tolstoy, he is gifted with an amazing spiritual power which however inspired every walk of his life. The writings, conversations and exhortations of Bhave are living testimonies to this power. The union of great moral and spiritual power and immense imaginative vision with a high sense of purpose coupled with some realistic details about socio-economic set-up at once make him one of the great popular Prophets of the Age. Acharya Vinoba Bhave like the Russian Reformer of

taking its roots in other continents of the world. This is all due to to the austere and enormous Tapasya of that great "Saint on the March" Vinoba, whose alchemic touch made me offer this first gift of land..From Sri V. Ramachandra Reddy's own version...*Birth of Bhoodan*....Vide Presidential address, the Fourth Andhra Pradesh Sarvodaya Sammelan, April, 1962.

11. The son of Amram born in 571 B.C. was the leader of Hebrews. Moses was primarily a law-giver and a religious teacher who liberated the Hebrews from bondage in Egypt. At the age of 80 Moses was called by God through a voice from the burning bush to return to Egypt to free the Hebrews. Moses then led his people to Mt. Siani from whose summit he brought down the tablets containing the Ten-Commandments. He died at Mt. Nebo at the age of 120.

the recent past is striving his best to implant the kingdom of Heaven upon Earth.¹²

John Ruskin¹³ the humanitarian writer who lived in the early part of the 19th century turned to Economics of his age and wrote innumerable thought-provoking articles which were later on re-published as 'Unto this Last.' All his writings aimed at economic emmancipation, social reform and national education of the masses. He wrote epigrammatic language and read Bible throughout his life. On the other hand Acharya Vinoba Bhave the living humanist of the present age with his egalitarian ideals of economic equality, social enlightenment and communitarian polity is fast tending to bring about social transformation through peaceful revolution. Every word of Acharya is accepted by the people as a valuable treasury of human good as he himself is the living embodiment of Good. John Ruskin pleaded for the laws of Social affection as necessary pre-requisites to the laws of Political Economy in the past. On the other hand Acharya Bhave preached the laws of

12. Biblical reference meaning spiritual reign of God. The province of God is considered to be free from all trial and trouble, despair and distress. *Kingdom of Heaven* is Blessedness of God.

13. The son of John James Ruskin was born in the early part of the 19th century. He was an art critic, author and social reformer. Ruskin in his later years became a severe critic of modern Industrialism, the degradation of the workmen and their artificial enslavement. He argues that true wealth lies in 'things that lead to life.' *Unto This Last*, *Scasame* and *Lilies* and *Modern painters* were considered to be his best works. Among his prominent disciples were William Morris and G. B. Shaw.

Social affection to accompany the self-governing laws of local community reform. This is indeed considered as a spiritual movement towards socio-economic emancipation of the masses. The self-regulating and self-governing ideals as the primary requisites of the participating democracy indeed gave a new turn to the agro-industrial economy of the nation in these days. John Ruskin is well-known as a critic of political economy while Acharya Bhawe is widely known as the Architect of the down-trodden and under-developed.

Schleiermacher¹⁴ who lived in the early part of the 18th century preached Ideal-realism which is the creative blend of the real as well as the ideal tendencies of life. The feeling of dependence of man on the superior power is the essence of religious consciousness according to the religious Prophet of Ideal-realism. On the other hand the feeling of dependence of man on the superior powers of Justice¹⁵ and Good sense of man form the subject-matter of

14. 18th century German philosopher and a theologian who in attempting to accommodate religion to the new scientific rationalistic views of his time, believed that religious ideas have symbolic value, in that they encouraged a life virtue. *Soliloquies* was his magnum-opus.

15. Nichomachean ethics of Aristotle distinguishes distributive justice from corrective justice. Distributive justice is followed by awards and the Corrective justice imposes some punishment. Aristotle once exclaimed and said of Justice that 'neither evening nor the morning star is so lovely.' The altruism of Aristotle is very well indicated through his over-emphasis on the positive aspect of justice. Justice includes all other virtues says Aristotle. Similarly

Sarvodaya Ideology. The religion, according to Vinoba Bhave is not seated in the emotional nature of man. Religion never excludes the elements of reason and volition. The mental field of man in admitting the principles of religious consciousness cannot by any reason reject the innate and the most essential attributes of his being i.e., the self-conscious *Samskaras*.¹⁶

Acharya Vinoba Bhave the walking Saint of India can be compared with innumerable spiritual sages and saints who dominated the world-thought through their selfless substantial action. To this category we can add St. Albans,¹⁷ St. Bernard,¹⁸ St. Gregory,¹⁹ and St. Albertus

Sarvodaya Ideology is fast tending to practice, distributive justice through its creative and noble mission of Bhoodan.

16. The affirmative principle of past life reflected as it is through present life on the basis of *Prarabdha-Karma*.

17. The first British martyr who is commemorated on June 22. He sacrificed his life at the altar of his firm faith in the poor. He disclaimed his bishopric of the Church and claimed his friendship of the commoners. He died fighting for his cause.

18. Was a perfect platonist of his century. He was a French ecclesiastic. He was an adversary of Abelard. He was known for his high sympathy and extreme simplicity. He preached a theory of universals similar to Gautama Buddha, i.e., existence in a state of wisdom.... *Bodhi-Sattva*.

19. He was popularly called as "Gregory-the-Great. He comes from a Patrician Roman family and soon became a benedictine monk. He loved and assisted the poor in a variety of ways. He enforced strict celibacy. It was he who sent Augustine to England on a mission of peace in 590. Gregorian-chant is analogous to Sarvodaya prayer.

Magnus²⁰ etc. However, the magical influence of Mohan Das Karamchand Gandhi upon his trusted and the most devoted disciple, Acharya Vinoba Bhave, cannot be overlooked. The impact of Gandhi on Vinoba is so immense that we cannot categorically say that the latter is much influenced by the former except saying that Vinoba is but the living, moving and inspiring shadow of Mahatma Gandhi. What Gandhiji has visualised to practise in his life itself, apart from what he has been practicing throughout is left to vinoba to practise in his present life.

20. The Bishop of Ratisbon was the teacher of St. Thomas Aquinas in 13th century. The followers of St. Albertus Magnus were called as Albertists. These were a group of scholastics at the University of Cologne during the 15th and 16th century. Albertists were opposed to Thomists. All Alberts were men of wisdom.

CHAPTER 1

THE BIRTH OF SARVODAYA

The birth of Sarvodaya Ideals can be traced back to John Ruskin's teachings contained in his 'Unto this Last'²¹ and Tolstoy's writings on 'Bread Labour.'²² However the contributions of Gandhi and the Russian writer Bon-

21. A book written by John Ruskin, the connoisseur of art and letters in 1860. The author criticising the then contemporary victorian society deplores the degradation of workmen and ever-increasing mechanisation of the age. He evolves a comprehensive moral and an ethical code of conduct in work.

22. That to live man must work is the basis of bread-labour. Tolstoy was the first to call body-labour as bread-labour. Action based on sacrifice is the source of all life. This action can be categorised as mental and physical. Intellectual work is as much needed as physical labour. 'Obedience to law of bread-labour will bring about a silent revolution in the structure of society' says Gandhi. Thus we have noted all through that action is the cause of all sacrifice, that is, *Yagna*. On similar lines the teachings of Gita insist and conclude that action is the cause of all life. Action is the cause of sacrifice, sacrifice is the cause of rain, rain, is the cause of food and ultimately life is the happy consequence of food...Vide Gita 3-(14).

daref²³ are no less significant analogies of Sarvodaya Ideology. Further, the teachings of Gita particularly the *Karma-Yoga* and the *Adhyatma-Yoga* which tend to teach the highest form of action give rise to various *dharma*s. Righteous inter-pretation of these *dharma*s itself implies a high sense of Sarvodaya Ideology. The Biblical saying that "In the sweat of thy brow shalt thou eat thy bread" denotes Sarvodaya way of life.

John Ruskin in his memorable book 'Unto this Last' wrote about the total uplift or the welfare of all i.e., *Sarvodaya*. He has gone further ahead to preach even the uplift of the last *Antyodaya*²⁴. This may be perhaps due to his natural inspiration derived from the Holy Bible. "That the good of the individual is contained in the good

23. Russian writer who believed in the divine law that a man must earn his living by labouring. This basic concept was widely popularised by the other Russian writer Count Leo Tolstoy through bread-labour. The same truth can be discovered in the Chapter III of Gita. Many great men like Sophocles, Sir J. Reynolds, Voltaire, Carlyle and Emerson have strongly insisted on earnest labour.

24. 'Sarvodaya' attained its maximum glory in 'Antyodaya.' The service to the needy and the benefit of all is merged into the generic ideal of welfare of the lowliest and the last. In social hierarchy we find that the poor form the base and the rich apex. It is commonly stated that necessity reforms the poor and satiety the rich. On the other hand 'Antyodaya' envisages a reform of the poor based on duty instead of necessity. The liberation of the sentient beings from their deep anguish may also be treated as one of the transforming ideals of 'Sarvodaya' through its generic aspect of *Antyodaya*...

of all;’ that the lawyers work has the same value as the Barber’s, as both have the same right of earning their livelihood from their work;’ and that ‘the life of the labourer and the life of the Tiller of the Soil is the life worth living’ form the three Cardinal truths of Ruskins’ ‘Unto this Last. The first Cardinal truth aims at the universality of objects, the second freedom of the individual and the third Cardinal truth tends to render dignity to the individuality of the poor. On our closer examination, we find that these welfare doctrines of ‘Unto this Last’ have their origin in the memorable teachings of St. Mathew.²⁵ When Jesus went away from Galilee and entered the region of Judaea, beyond Jordan, large crowds followed him. Jesus referring to the Kingdom of Heaven said that most of them will receive a hundred fold and thus inherit Eternal Life. But many that are first will be last, and the last first. In order to explain this metaphysical truth, Jesus Christ according to St. Mathew’s interpretation cited the example of a householder who went out early in the morning to hire labourers for his Vineyard. In his first- encounter the householder agreed to pay a Denarius* each-a-day to the workless way-farers and so he sent them all to work into his Vineyard. After three hours he went out again and saw some more labourers standing in the Market place and he asked them too to work in his Vineyard and that whatever is right he would pay them. So the second batch of workers went into Vineyard. The householder once again went out about the sixth-hour and ninth-hour and

25. First century Saint an apostle of Christ who wrote the first Gospel to his fellow Jews. The book of Mathew is considered as one of the historical books constituting a synoptic Gospel.

* Worth about 20 cents in those days.

he did the same. Finally, about the eleventh-hour when the householder went out, he found some others yet standing un-hired all the day. The householder asked them too, to go and work in his Vineyard. When the day was over, the owner of the Vineyard gave instructions to his trusted steward "call the labourers and pay them their wages beginning with the Last, upto the First." So all of them came beginning with the last and each received a Denarius without any discrimination. When the first employed came last, they thought that they would get more, but each of them received a Denarius. This generous act of the householder however created a great dissatisfaction among those who came first. As a result they grumbled at the owner of the Vineyard and abused him greatly and they even called him unjust. When, those who sustained the burden of the whole day in the scorching heat of the Sun, were treated, equally with those who worked less and exerted less, they badly felt not only jealous of the latter but they extremely became violent at their owner. The householder astonishingly said 'am I not allowed to do what I choose with what belongs to me'? 'Did I not give you what I had promised to give'? The labourers replied in one-voice Yes! 'you did give.' Then why do you begrudge my generosity? said the owner; 'so the last will be first and the first last' in my scheme of events.²⁶

26. In capitalistic-set up there is significant social hierarchy wherein the labour is dealt with as a commodity. There is no scope for human considerations whatsoever. On the other hand a communitarian society renders some intrinsic values to labour and so there is scope for human and social considerations of work. The 'Sarvodaya' ideals apart from their equitable values of work benefit the last in rank

In the recent past there has been again a revival of Sarvodaya and Antyodaya in the philosophical movement lead by Acharya Vinoba Bhave. Sarvodaya as a well-integrated social philosophy of the age has brought with it several other welfare trends which tend to enrich its scope extensively, more particularly in the contemporary period. The social significance of Sarvodaya is increasingly enlarged much due to its new interpretation of some of the basic social concepts like *Dan and Dharma*, *Ahimsa* and *Aparigraha* and *Loka-Sangraha*. The other well-known concept of Sarvodaya Samaj include the generic ideals of *Janashakti*, the democratic ideals of *Gram Sabha* and the communitarian ideals of *Gram Panchayat*.

first and then tend to extend their ardent attention to the first by a graded mechanism of transformation. 'Sarvodayis' go by root to the shoot which is considered by them as natural justice. This can indeed be called as social radicalism. Such unique and a-typical ideals of equanimity can be discovered in Bible and Gita.

CHAPTER II

THE ECONOMIC ASPECT OF SARVODAYA

In this way Sarvodaya is both all-comprehensive and all-inclusive ideology. It is at once Universal in its scope. It pervades each and every aspect of Society economic, social, ethical, moral and religious. On the economic plane it teaches a live-principle of equal advantages. The ideal of man, according to Sarvodaya includes economic pursuits apart from moral gains. The economic needs of man and his non-economic pursuits are well approximated in Sarvodaya Ideology. It is a golden mean of rigid economic determinism and complacent social realism. *Isha-upanishad*²⁷ teaches that the life in the realm of the physical and the life in the realm of the spiritual are not incompatible. They are one and the same. Each is the *Pratibimba* or the true reflection of the other. Real-physical or material is the Ideal-moral and spiritual. Acharya Vinoba Bhave is struggling and aiming at a change in the moral and the spiritual horizons of man through massive

27. One of the 13 of the oldest treatises antedating for the most part the beginning of Greek philosophy. *Isha* is considered to be one of the chief theological documents of ancient Hinduism. It states that pre-eminently in each human soul is seated the supreme, impersonal *Brahman*. It is said to have influenced immensely the works of W. B. Yeats, T. S. Eliot and Aldous Huxley.

and extensive trans-evaluation²⁸ of the socio-economic values of human existence in modern times. The unit of this prodigious movement is *Loka Sevak*, the ideal ahead is *Loka Sangraha*,²⁹ the philosophy of action is *Sarvodaya*, the weavon used is *Ahimsa* and the way trod is *Karma-yoga*. If an action is performed without any sort of attachment it itself is the means to the higher knowledge. The non-possession of other's wealth or property—*Aparigraha*³⁰ forms one of the main doctrines of Sarvodaya Samaj. Sarvodaya ideology over-emphasises on the universal moral

28. This word is of recent origin. Julean Huxley the world known American Biologist and a reputed writer of theological orientation interpreted a new humanism in modern times, that is, *trans-humanism*—a view in which interest in human welfare is not only primary but evolutionary. Evaluation based on extra-sensory-perception is called *trans-evaluation*. This is analogous to the generic concept *Ishta-Sadhana* or the realisation of values in objects or events of Indian thought. There is no difference whatsoever between this type of social evaluation and the so-called social realisation.

29. The ideal of 'Sarvodaya' being the total uplift of one and all, tends to cover the betterment of the whole world. The over-all transformation of the entire race of mankind on all levels of human existence, constitutes the *being-qua-being* of 'Sarvodaya' Ideology.

30. In the heart of all objects of Nature, God alone is Reality. He alone exists in everything as essential Reality. Whatever there is changeful in the ephemeral world, all that must be enveloped by the Lord. By renunciation of the above world of vainglory, support and enrich your being. Whatsoever covet no man's wealth. Vide *Isha-Upanishad*.

i.e., *Lokaniti* of mankind in the pursuit of its universal ideal i.e., *Sarvadharmā Samanātva*. The release of infinite moral energy of the whole world in the benefit of its race is called *Lokashakti* and the pooling of general man-power and harnessing its inner resources is called *Jan-Shakti*.³¹ Sarvodaya Samaj tends to evolve an egalitarian concept of Man in modern times which is at once rare hitherto unknown to the economic claims of man.³²

In the Rigvedic period the Indian economic administration took a new turn wherein the king was regarded as the sole guardian of the political economy of the State. There was much of voluntary imposition on the part of the king with respect to the economic resources of the nation. There was a sort of self-imposed autocracy and the king was never, by any means, a despot. On the other hand he was bound by the Law of *Dharma* which had social, moral

31. *Jan-Shakti* is not the physical man-power but it indicates a moral force and nay even the soul-force of the entire mass of men. It cannot, however, be measured in kilowatts and horse-power. It is a tremendous fountain of energy which knows no mortal measure. Collective will, moral force and general volition are but conventional manifestations of *Jan-Shakti*.

32. Man is considered to be the microcosm of the great cosmic Nature macrocosm. This is mere finite-infinite, part-whole interpretation of man; on the other hand man as the symbol of good, emblem of virtue, embodiment of values and image of God, is the real concept of man.

and religious sanction. In the happiness of the Subjects lay the happiness of the Ruler.³³

The ancient Indian economy of wealth is very well interpreted by the best known treatise on *Arthashastra* written by *Kautilya*,³⁴ the most popular minister of Chandragupta Maurya. It encouraged economic activity by developing trade and industry, agriculture and other sources of economic progress and by affording equal opportunities to all citizens of the State irrespective of their caste and class distinctions. The Maurean economy of wealth and power was based on social welfare and economic well-being.³⁵

33. The ancient Indian polity laid down that economic activities were essential pre-conditions of the real life of a State. The economic life of the State was controlled under a system of corporation, but it was made independent of the political life. Thus the ancient heritage of kingship and state-craft was ideal.

The main occupation of the people was agriculture and their chief wealth was cattle. Some of them devoted themselves to industrial pursuit as spinning, weaving, pottery, tanning, carpentry, chariot-making and craftsmanship in gold and iron. Even women were no exception as the dress worn by the bridegroom on the day of marriage was woven by the bride herself. Trade was carried on by a barter system. King was the leader of his clan as the people were divided into different clans to meet any emergency. Criminal justice was entirely in the hands of the King. Although Vedic economic Society was primitive, its unit was joint family and the King was its sole monarch. "A greater sovereign than the King was 'Dharma.' The religious, ethical, social, political, juridic and customary law organically governing the

life of the people." Vide The Spirit and Form of Indian Polity...Sri Aurobindo.

34. 'Kautalya' also known as 'Chanakya,' the author of *Artha-Sastra* is widely known to the curious minds all over the world. His work confirms to the Maurean Codes of science and arts of Government. *Artha*=source of livelihood of men; *Sastra*=the art or science. Thus *Artha-Sastra* is the science and art of Government. It, however, deals in general with the social history of the earlier times and in particular it reflects the state-craft of the Maurean period. Kautalya was a celebrated statesman a sage and a diplomat. There were numerous Schools of *Artha-Sastra* which have been defined as the *Dharma-Sastras*. There is much evidence to say that *Kautalya* was also called as 'Vishnu-Gupta,' 'Chanakya-Niti' is considered as synonymous with diplomacy in India. Chanakya actively assisted Chandragupt Maurya, the grandfather of Ashoka in his pioneering expeditions to protect Magadha. Kautalya comes from 'Kutula-Gotra'...Vide *Chanakya and Artha-Sastra* by Somnath Dhar. The Indian Institute of World Culture.

35. Megasthenes writes that numerous arts and crafts, specially in metals and textiles, were followed by the people. The State provided some opportunities for the poor, indigent men and helpless and destitute women. The Maurean emperor was an autocrat and a monarch; but he seldom used his powers according to his wishes. The King was almost the father of his subjects. His primary duty was to protect the weak and the poor. The people were to pay 1/4 of their produce towards the taxes. Truth and virtue were highly regarded by the people and when a foreigner fell ill, he was at once treated by the royal physician of the State.

In the Buddhistic period³⁶ small republics and tiny states rose which resembled the much later set-up of the continental type of Feudalism based on Serfs and Villains. Thus the economic organisation of both wealth and power encouraged communal life of the people which ultimately resulted in socio-economic disgust and general pessimism.

The economic ideals of Christianity³⁷ are unique. The socio-economic organisation of man has nothing to do

36. There were number of States existing in Buddha's times which were not ruled by a single King but a number of Kings holding hereditary offices. The people were divided into tribes and the most important of them were the *Sakyas*. The economic life of the village was sound and men of special crafts like carpenters and smiths etc., had villages of their own. The affairs of the village were settled under a grove outside the village. Forced labour was absent but the law of debt was severe. Vide *Social and Political Thought of Buddhist Writers* by K. B. Krishna.

37. Christianity preached spiritual renewal neglecting the changes in the socio-economic order of the community. The doctrines of Marxism succeeded in solving the economic problems of man; the doctrines of socialism proceeded in effecting social changes, whereas the doctrines of Christianity devoted entirely towards bringing about moral and spiritual changes. Strictly speaking, all these approaches have been one-sided attempts to improve one sector of life to the exclusion of the other equally important sector. Against such a background of distinctively divided economies there arises an imperative and momentous need to evolve a welfare economy based on communitarian polity. Vide *Erich Fromm, Economics of Christianity*.

with the inner change of heart. The catholic church preached the qualitative doctrines of universal social interest. Thus Christianity had to solve a number of puzzling problems not only relating to economic sphere but it had to justify faith to reason and defend itself against the hard attacks of the publicists.

The economics of Islamic society³⁸ envisages a comprehensive code of social conduct. Excluding the income which is necessary to maintain the standards of living *Nasab* the surplus part of the income is utilised for the general benefit of the society *Zakat*. The equability of

38. The word *Islam* denotes a submission to the will of God. Etymologically the term *Islam* means "to resign one-self." The welfare of humanity implies true sense of sacrifice. The injunctions of the Holy Quran upon the economic aspect of man are not many but the implied and inferential conclusions can be drawn as already stated above. Vide Prof. Moynuddin Quadri's *Treatise on Economic Aspects of Islam*.

The welfare state is commonly signified as a State which has a co-ordinated economic planning and a constructive social engineering. Welfare economy is an all-sided economy. However, in totalitarian welfare economies there is greater scope for exclusive total-welfare of the community. On the other hand in communitarian welfare economies there is unlimited scope for the natural growth of the individual apart from the general and over-all progress of the community. Almost all the free nations of the world are considered to be cultivating welfare economies. Vide Jai Prakash's *draft on Indian Polity*.

The modern concept of a welfare State was not a new one, but one that had been laid down by the ancient Kings of India even from early times.

wealth is based both on the rich, each according to his wealth and on the poor, each according to his needs. Thus the Islamic outlook of economic theory is normative as against the positive approach of Robins. The words "*Salah*" and *Falah* are commonly used to denote the altruistic trend of Islamic economics i.e., *Al-af*.

The functions of a modern Welfare State, according to Adam Smith's 'Wealth of Nations,' include the economic and protective functions apart from other social and political functions. The economic functions of the State are viewed as necessary functions in almost all the welfare economies of the present-day world.

The economy of the community is an important aspect of Polity. Without proper economy of the community, there cannot be any welfare of the community. The community's economy should not merely be co-operative but co-sharing, says Sarvodaya. The science of Economics must be integrated in order to evolve integral social personalities, observed Dr. Schumacher.³⁹ Gandhi and Vinoba, however, laid a new foundation for new science of economics in modern times by injecting human element into the economy of the community. The society which is based on the 'renewable resources' is the real society and other

39. Dr. E. F. Schumacher is the economic Adviser to the British National Coal Board. He is now in India at the invitation of the Planning Commission. He is a noted British economist who is engaged in propagating rural industrialisation on Gandhian lines. He pleads for new perspectives in the present planning of India. Urban and rural planning should have separate programmes. Rural uplift needs more attention than urban development are one of his main themes at present.

societies which have their economic roots in the 'non-renewable resources' are considered as erroneous, unsubstantial and non-real. Vinoba envisages a self-sufficient economy of the community. The modern Industrial Organisation has caused atomization ⁴⁰ of society reducing the individual to a helpless unit ruled by non-human physical forces. So, the communitarian society of Vinoba Bhave is primarily engaged in satisfying the human needs. The 'economic inequality is inconsistent with the spirit of the community' is indeed a fact. The unit of economic society is economic wealth whereas the unit of communitarian society is the individual worker. Work is the purposeful expression of the fruitful resources of Man.

If we study some of the modern Business Laws of economic wealth in the aforesaid background of Sarvodaya Ideology we find that they need a lot of social attention and thus need a thorough reorientation. When there is a scarcity of essential commodity in the markets of merchandise, the demand being constant, there is a corresponding rise in its normal price. Again in case where there is a rise in demand for the same commodity, the production being constant, there is again a corresponding rise in its price.⁴¹

40. Economics of Materialism has caused atomisation of society. The Universality of the economic aspect in modern times is completely rooted in mechanical aspect of social progress. The Science of economics as taught today throughout the world, recognises no other factor other than that of itself as instrument of life. On the other hand the new economics of which we stand in need is that which is not based on mere material progress but which gives us a new status of liberation, an authentic individuality and high sense of self-hood. Such an economics may

lead the present man to synechism instead of atomism or atomisation of society. Already we are too much strained and over-burdened by the so-called social stratifications of the age. Added to this the Western economies of materialism projected the new evil of atomisation. Atomisation determines not only division in social existence but indicates a sort of disintegration of social personality of man. Gandhian economics rooted in *Swadeshi and Khadder* was its sole remedy. 'Present Western polity based upon an atomised society, the State being made-up of an inorganic sum of individuals. This is both against the social nature of man and the scientific organisation of society. Ancient Indian polity was much more consistent with these both. Vide *Introduction to Reconstruction of Indian Polity* by Jai Prakash Narain.

41. The modern economics of Materialism has created many ramifications in the normal price structure. The selfish motive of man is modified into his profit motive. As a result he has become very crazy and wants to have profit at all cost. He has lost all human considerations whatsoever. He is all-out for fixing high prices if he is a business man. On either occasions, that is, when there is scarcity of the commodity and when there is rise in its demand, there is a corresponding rise in its price when production being constant. Here we find that the selfish nature of man is invariably governed by non-economic substitutes more than economic factors. One of the cardinal truth of Sarvodaya is *Aparigraha* or non-possession. Quite nearer to this concept is *Asvadham* or non-holding. On the other hand the economics of modern materialism is encouraging accumulation of wealth in the hands of the few owners of business through progressive monopolisation and rapid control of commodities both essential and non-essential. Some altruistic theory of economics is the only way-out.

On the other hand if the modern businessman tends to categorise the demand under essential wants, common needs and uncommon luxuries and fixes their prices keeking in his view the general laws of social happiness, much of the present-day malady can be eliminated. Economic and social exploitation will have no role to assume. The monopoliser will be deprived of his bad intention of hoarding and controlling the essential commodities. Again, if the Businessman minimises the graded prices of the common essential commodities as far as his trade permits and maximises the standard prices of the uncommon luxury goods then also the general social happiness can never run down the optimum level of social scale under any circumstances. This attempt on the part of a social scientist or a Sarvodaya worker may inhibit the general motivations of society but the good results are more than the bad causes. Such a retributive and corrective socio-economic formula can only be feasible when the law of economic demand is governed by the beneficent laws of human and social affection.⁴² This however very clearly indicates that the proper application of the welfare ideals to the so-called rigid laws of economic demand can however bring into being a noetic

42 John Ruskin was of the firm opinion that the modern science of economics is so-distant and so we can never call it as the science of political economy. It is filled with avarice and greed. There is no scope for human and social affection. 'It is easy to imagine an enthusiastic affection existing among soldiers for the Colonel. Not so easy to imagine an enthusiastic affection among cotton-spinners for the Proprietor of the Mill.' Vide. *Ruskin's 'Unto This Last.'*

society⁴³ which is humanistic than deterministic, altruistic than egoistic. Similarly, in the case of Laws of Monopolisation of commodities, if the business community realises the fast in-creeping social inflation, born out of certain accidental social upheavals like war and famine, and fixes the monopoly prices of commodities according to the class of commodity and the kind of demand, the days are not far off when we establish a perfect socio-economic concord in the modern community life. Again, if the laws of economic planning, the laws of decentralisation and the laws of socio-economic reform function within their own well-defined structural frame-work moved and governed by some of the simple and natural laws of basic human sympathy, we can await for a new era based on natural beneficence and unprecedented social sympathy. The welfare doctrines of Sarvodaya economics, thus tend to popularise the laws of individual realisation, social affection and gene-

43. The noetic society of Sarvodaya is *Shosana-Vihina-Samaj* which pleads for *Sarva-dharma-Samanatva*. If the human laws of social affection are properly applied to the rigid and deterministic laws of economics, the Society according to Sarvodaya is bound to evolve some new values in human relations in the sphere of business hitherto unknown to the claims of man. The *Shosana-Vihina-Samaj* resembles in some respects with the ideal State of Plato. The theory of the ideal State in the Republic entails the abolition of monogamous marriage, family life and of private property for two classes of people; the philosopher-Kings, the guardians of the State or soldiers so as to enable them to devote all the time to the normal duties of the State. The only difference between them is that the former contends for a conscious subjugation of the ruler to his State while the later suggests a total devotion of the individual to the State-protection.

ral human sympathy. The over-all outlook of Sarvodaya Ideology neutralises all forms of economic determinism, social regorism and the general human antagonism. The Gandhian economy of wealth, like Sarvodaya, indicates a high sense of human good. The self-supporting and self-reforming outlook of life is indeed considered as the pragmatic movement of Gandhian ideology towards a higher life of economic prosperity and social advancement. The Gandhian approach to economic wealth is both remunerative and reformative. On the other hand the recent tendencies of Sarvodaya ideology aim at the educative and the restorative ideals of economic growth. This approach may be called as Humanistic Communitarianism.⁴⁴ The Humanistic Communitarian polity is never antagonistic to any of the modern forms of Class-Capitalism, Total-Communism, Scientific or Radical Socialism. It is indeed inimical to all forms of Animism, Archaism and Rabetism, which tend to disintegrate the humanitarian and the egalitarian synthetic ideals of social communitarianism. Sarvodaya can never be a negative and destructive approach to life and society, on the other hand it

44. In 'Sarvodaya' way of life, equal emphasis is being laid on man and Society. A sort of social dynamics is being established between the two. The individual realisation is as much important as social evolution. Both the human ideal and the social ideal are viewed together. The basic human sympathy and the radical social reform go hand-in-glove in 'Sarvodaya Samaj.' The self-hood and the social good never exclude one another. The individual-self is but reflection of social-self. In short the entire society is humanistic, altruistic and organismic. Thus humanistic communitarianism is a golden mean between ignominious Individualism and common Collectivism.

always adopts a positive and ameliorative outlook towards both life and society as it invariably envisages an integral ideology of *Sarva-dharma-Samanatva*. The concepts of 'Dan' and 'Dharma' need some explanation.⁴⁵

Dan is not mere charity, it involves the self-purity of the individual concerned. *Dan* is a generic ideal of Sarvodaya Samaj. There are many forms of *Dan*, as *Sampathi-Dan*, *Shrama-Dan*, *Gupta-Dan* and *Jivan-Dan* in Sarvodaya. *Dan* is the essential element of Sarvodaya philosophy. However, the social significance of *Dan* and its general philosophical implication is yet to be discovered by us.

The concept of *Dharma*⁴⁶ was of great significance to the ancient Indian polity. *Dharma* is synonymous with

45. According to Shankaracharya a gift is an equitable distribution, that is, *Danam-Sama-Vibhaga*. 'Dan' is a dynamic concept in 'Sarvodaya.' Both the giver and the receiver will have equal advantages in sharing the virtue. In the words of Srinadha, the great Telugu poet, the giver is at a greater advantage than the receiver. A donor of land is blessed for ever. He is free from the scorching rays of the sun, the fire flames of hearth and nay free from the clutches of mortal death...Vide *Bhima-Swara-Puranam*.

46. Immense significance is attached to the word "dharma" in Indian philosophy. Nothing good or virtuous, universal or eternal is there which is not included under 'dharma.' The word "Varna-dharma" is used in connection with social classes. The kshtriya class which was solely meant for defence of the community, had to safeguard both the inner and the outer aspects of social life in the past. The inner aspect being 'satya' and the outer 'dharma.' In this way 'Varna-dharma' could establish a proper concord between

the German conception of *Sittlichkeit*. *Dharma* can never be a code of conduct. On the other hand it is a way of life *Wyawastha*. Economic and social equalities also imply *Dharma* as much as moral goals and spiritual ideals are ever continued to be viewed in terms of *Dharma*. *Dharma* holds a comprehensive concept in Sarvodaya while *Dan* is a partial concept of *Dharma*. *Dharma* is viewed as the total ideal of humanity while *Dan* is considered as *Samajik* *wyawastha* of man.

The economic aspect of society was dealt by innumerable creative thinkers of the past. The French Physiocrats⁴⁷ opposed the old mercantile system of Europe at

relative morality i.e., 'niti' and the absolute morality i.e., 'niyam.' On the other hand 'varnasrama-dharma' indicates an emphasis on social morality instead of individual morality. *Sadharna-dharmas* are those duties which are common to all like kindness, goodness, charity, benevolence and forbearance. 'Buddha' was called as 'dharma-kaya' or the regulator of the universe even 'dharma-Bhutajnana.' Vatsyanana in his impulsive commentary on an early 'sutra' of Gautama delineates 'dharma' as the crown of right conduct. 'sattva-suddhi' or the cleansing of the heart is preparatory act to 'dharma.' However, the significance of the word '*dharma*' became manifold when Buddha was called as 'dharma-kaya,' the regulator of the universe.

47. Physiocrats were group of economists who lived in the early part of the 18th century. Physiocrat is one of a School of political economy founded in France. That the soil is the sole source of all wealth, that Society should be governed by inherent natural order and that Government is a necessary evil etc.. were considered to be their main fundamental doctrines.

the close of the Middle Ages. They however advocated a new economic philosophy which pleaded that each individual as a citizen has a natural right to assert his conscious activity in the economic sphere of his own state. This can be viewed however as the beginning of a new economic revolt in the West.

In the later years J. S. Mill⁴⁸ also pointed out that the different forms of social happenings invariably and unconditionally depend upon the economic resources of man. This is the beginning of the concept of social and political economy in the West. On the other hand the economic concept of the community contained in Sarvodaya never discriminates the two ideals i.e., Economic and Social as separate entities. The economy of the community and the welfare of the community are re-concilable realities because the community comprehends the whole man in his collective existence and not the man in his separate individual

Physiocrats advocated *laissez-faire* and pleaded for single tax on land. Adam Smith, a British Economist of the same period became an ardent follower of physiocrats and being influenced by their natural doctrines, wrote his famous book 'The Wealth of Nations' which exposed the evils of mercantilism.

48. J. S. Mill was the son of James Mill, a British philosopher and Economist who lived in the later part of the 18th century. He pleaded for the authentic individuality and absolute liberty of the individual in all his writings. 'On Liberty' is a classic defence of the natural rights of man. The primary object of all Governments is to promote the welfare of its subjects. J. S. Mill was much influenced by Bentham and his Utilitarianism.

entity.⁴⁹ Thus, the economic ideal of Sarvodaya Samaj includes all other ideals social, moral, ethical and spiritual. Sarvodaya is indeed a creative and a synthetic philosophy of life.

Sarvodaya Samaj implores a fearless hard-work⁵⁰ based on moral and ethical values. This idea of 'Bread-labour' was widely popularised by Count Leo Tolstoy, the

49. The philosophy of man reveals several aspects of the existence of man. The human aspect of man considers man as a separate entity. It studies both miseries and the excellencies of the species of man as a whole. The social aspect of man treats man as a unit of society, the political aspect of man examines the role of man in a State etc., and the universal aspect of man views him as a collective identity. The total Man or the whole Man is the blend of all the above aspects of man. The wholeness of man represents the goodness of man. Thomas Hill Green in the West and Rabindranath Tagore in the East have constructed a consistent theory of man in recent history. The perfection of man implies his devotion to moral self, intuitive reason and spiritual conscience. Holiness is lasting mode of perfection of his spirit. Altruistic ideal is the ideal of essential or total man. Sarvodaya always views man in his wholeness.

50. Verily, those who eat the remains after distributing away *Yagna-Shishta-Annam* i.e., remains of sacrifice are invariably released from all forms of sin; but those wicked people who cook for their own sake and eat thereby will eat nothing but sin. Here the *bhavana* or the inward attitude of the righteous and the impious is examined. There is also a Vedic text which indicates similar substance i.e., "one who does not nourish the guests and eats alone, eats but sin." Vide... Gita. 3-(12).

Russian writer for the first time in the 18th century. In the same period and even earlier, John Ruskin, the English writer of Eminence wrote about Bread-labour in his memorable book 'Unto This Last.' "To live a man must work hard" said Ruskin. Similar ideas about hard-work and productive labour can be discovered in the writings of another Russian Writer Bondaref. The teachings of Gita are indeed considered as a living testimony to the inspiring ideas of Bread-labour.⁵¹ 'He who eats without sacrifice, eats stolen food' says Gita and again the memorable saying of the New Testament of the Bible goes to say 'In the sweat of thy brow shalt thou eat thy bread.' According to Vinoba Bhave a self-sufficient village republic is based much upon the hard-work of the villager. A proper blend of the conscious physical-labour and thoughtful intellectual work alone can establish *Gram-Raj*. Whether one is a Sadhu or a Saint, a Samrat or a Ruler or he is a Bhangi or a Scavenger, he must put-in hard-work. This is the *Manava-Dharma* or rule of life for all mankind. There can be no exception to hard-work.⁵² The Indian

51. He eats but sin, who cooks but for himself. On the other hand the food of what remains after sacrifice i.e., *Yagna-Shista-annam* is ordained as the ideal food of the good and the virtuous. The real eater of food is one who eats the remains of the food after his due service to the rest i.e., *Yagna-Seshaha*. Vide Manusmriti 3-(318). He who enjoys the gifts bestowed by others without giving others in return is undoubtedly a thief. Vide—Gita 3-(12).

52. Hard work is the basis of both *Yoga* and *Yagna*. The mental values of work should be balanced with the physical values of work by all means. There can be no exception to hard work whatsoever.

rulers for example State Administrators and Popular Ministers should imbibe very well this *Raja-Niti*. Sarvodaya will never relegate into the background *Raja-Niti* the morality of the rulers when it tends to preach *Loka-Niti* the world morality. There are some principles laid down by Sarvodaya to be strictly followed by the rulers of the States. The rulers⁵³ and those who are in authority must develop chaste social and moral habits, inculcate some

Even a Judge who is meant to dispense justice must be engaged in manual labour at least for four hours in a day, says Vinoba. The discussion between the disciple and the Preceptor in *Kenopanishad* centres round the Saving knowledge of the world. Austerity, Reticence and Devoted hard-work, are the real foundations of saving knowledge of the Upanishads. The Vedas are considered to be its primary appendages and truth is treated as its principal abode...Vide *Kenopanishad*, Chapter 4-(8).

53. The ruler of the Republic of Plato differs from the ruler of *Shosana-Vihina-Samaj* of Sarvodaya. The ruler is invariably a philosopher who is competent to rule, yet he will not undertake the responsibility of the State except under conditions of compulsion. Again, the ruler of the Republic is engrossed deeply in the study of the Ideas more than the study of the affairs of the Government. On the other hand the ruler of Sarvodaya-Samaj, embodies in him the qualities of both the ruler and the ruled and for this reason alone he can rule best than others. This characteristic difference can be elucidated by a symbolic ensample of the Upanishads. The two birds bound one to the other in close relationship perch on the self-same tree. One of them eats the fruits of the tree with relish while the other looks on without eating...Vide *Mundaka-Upanishad* Chapter III Sec. 1-(1).

genuine and sympathetic heart-cultures, possess certain human qualities of honesty and integrity and above all they must be able to lay their living faith in *Ahimsa* or non-violence. When the rulers follow these cardinal rules, they invariably adopt *Varnashrama-Dharma* and they can ever serve people as a matter of right. *Swartha*⁵⁴ or self-interest must not find a place in their scheme of events. On the other hand *Paramartha* or Social interest should be their only and primary concern. A ruler according to Sarvodaya should be a *Kanchana-Mukta*⁵⁵ i.e., one who is free

54. Money is the source of evil as much as it is the medium of good. Contempt for money is as bad as the love of money. Love of money is the root of all evil and not mere money. Alexander was the real archetype of *Aparigraha* in the West as much as Ashoka was the real symbol of *Aparigraha* in the East. Money is not required to buy even one necessary of the soul. The craze for money and the race for riches has deprived man of his real wealth. The real wealth of man is the wealth of values. Somehow money makes ugly all it touches. Thus Sarvodaya pleads primarily for a liberation of man from the present slavery of money so that he can become the best medium of all-round service, i.e., *Samagra-Seva*.

55. The conception of matter has conditioned man so much in modern times that the latter has lost all his altruistic impulses, ethical objectives, human values and moral ideals. He has become a mechanical robot. He can neither like himself nor like others. He has lost all individuality. He ceased to be an identity by himself. He is not only de-individualised creature, but he is also a de-humanised being. He lost all sympathy for others. He is not prepared to receive any good from his species and presently he is not in

from the slavery of money. The all-round service to humanity is the living ideal of Sarvodaya i.e., *Samagra-Seva*.⁵⁶

a position to impart any good to it. This is an added irony of his existence.

56. In Indian thought service unto man is service unto God. Selfless work is the nucleus of all moral philosophy. Isa-Upanishad states that one should live all his days only working. Gita emphasises on *nish-kama-karma* or disinterested activity, Baudha and Sankhya insist on the ideal of *Jivan-Mukta* and Sarvodaya glorifies *shoshana-vihina-samaj*.

CHAPTER III

THE SOCIAL ASPECT OF SARVODAYA

The social ideal of Sarvodaya is *Shoshana-Vihina-Samaj*. Modern society is becoming rigid day by day. The State of unauthentic existence of man and his impersonal element have however proved inimical and antithetical to his basic individuality. The speedy atomization of modern mechanized society is fast resulting in de-individualisation and de-humanisation of man in modern times. As a result there is much of economic and social exploitation. The *conflicts*⁵⁷ between man and man on one hand and the conflicts between man and his environment on the other side are rapidly multiplying with the ever-growing complexities of human and social existence. The Sarvodaya Samaj is indeed aiming at *Shashana-Mukta*. The ideals of Buddha in the past were meant mainly to transform the

57. Bertrand Russel, the living British Philosopher of this age explained the nature of triphasic conflict among homosapeans.

1. Conflict between man and himself;
2. Conflict between man and man;
3. Conflict between man and Nature.

The Sarvodaya ideal of liberation implies the infringement from all conflict and contest.

evil society into an ideal one. The *Mahayana*⁵⁸ teachings of Buddhism implied the liberation of the Sentient beings of the world. There is no liberation whatsoever other than the liberation of this world. A man can attain liberation in his own life-time through his real service to the people. One can attain the State of *Jivan-Mukta* in this world only through serving⁵⁹ his Kinsmen selflessly, honestly and faithfully. Sarvodaya, on the other hand is tending to establish an existential communion among men. The communitarian concept of man is indeed an improvement over the social concept of man. The *Swadharma* or the external existence of man should agree with his inner being i.e., *Swabhava* says Sarvodaya.⁶⁰ The age-old concept of man and his

58. A non-orthodox School of Buddhism called commonly as a Great Vehicle of Buddhism. Devotion to the salvation of the sentient beings is one of its main doctrines. It manifests itself in the worship of *Bodhi-Sattva*. It soon spread far and wide due to its all comprehensive character. A *Mahayain* believes in sharing others sorrows and miseries. Mahayana Buddhism spread as far as Tibet, China, Korea and Japan.

59. According to Vinoba all-round service to society is not a mere simultaneous act. It implies an over-all vision of the whole-work of society. If a man is fully engrossed in a particular work and his concentration becomes exclusive to that work, he fails to understand the very context or purpose of that work. So he remains a failure in his work. On the other hand, if a man works intensely with all-round vigilance without any one sided polarisation, his concentration gets doubled and his work is easily accomplished. In modern psychology this is called *Gestalt outlook* opposed to psychoanalytical approach.

60. It is better to follow sincerely one's own vocation however imperfect it may be in itself rather than

pursuing after some others vocations however perfect they may be. It is all the more happy to die performing one's own duty on no risk instead of embracing others duties however much colourful they may appear to us, as all such duties are always fraught with danger. There are certain laws to be followed in our lives. These laws differ from person to person. If we follow them perfectly it is considered as life-fulfilled. Instead, if we are inclined more and more towards following others laws, we may not follow them perfectly. Besides, in the latter case we are unnaturally deprived of our natural happiness of work. So, however distasteful and disagreeable one's duty may be, one must be faithful to it even towards the end of his life without any divergence whatsoever. Better to die honourably in one's own profession, rather than to accept others duty and live on others profession. One man's food may be another man's poison. One man's duty may be to serve the community by discharging his duties as a teacher, other man's duty may be to serve his own family as a father, and some other man's duty may be to serve his nation by discharging his duties as a soldier. A man is judged by the spirit of his service and not by the nature of his work. In this connection we can give the example of dramatic art in order to explain the significance of one's duties of performance. If there are five characters in a play one of a Maiden Queen, the other of a Minstrel, the third of a Messenger, the fourth a Mineal and the last Marshal, none can be treated in terms of their noble roles in the play, but they are always viewed in terms of their best acting. The Mineal can excell the Marshal in his acting and the Messenger's performance may be more natural than that of the Queen of the Court. Similarly a man's real actions are not judged in terms of his profession he pursues in his life but the nature or mode of performance of his actions is always taken into consideration. Vide Gita 3-(35).

relation to society is changed now. The individual was originally considered as the unit of society and the society was viewed as a mere group of individuals. Now man is a live-principle and society is a generic ideal. Thus Sarvodaya concept of man and society is dynamic. Man is regarded as the nucleus of society whereas society is considered as the organic whole of man. A disgregate group of human individuals is more than the mere totality of their individual qualities. Thus the product of men is not the totality of men. It is something more. The consequence is more than its cause. This is what is called as the process of creative synthesis of society.⁶¹ Sarvodaya has even gone ahead of this dynamic inter-action of man. Man is the animating hiatus of altruistic impulses while society is the inspiring focus of hectic virtue. The service of man is the normal creed of man *Niyam* and again, his sacrifice

61. The dynamics of society has presented a new synthesis in modern times called the Creative Synthesis. The inter-action of the individual taste and talent and the inter-penetration of values intellectual, moral and aesthetic with the social norms will result in a number of progressive social situations from time to time. This concept is not only progressive but evolutionary. Ordinary synthesis proceeds from the simple elements to the complex association from individual parts to the collective whole. In simple synthesis $A+B=AB$; in creative synthesis $A+B=C$. In the former case the resultant is the mere combination of the two components while in the latter case the resultant is the new product which is independent of the two components.

is his essential moral *Niti*. Sarvodaya adopts *Satyagraha*⁶² as its sole weapon of social change. *Satyagraha* is not merely a state-ideal but it is something more than it. It is both a human ideal and a living faith *Sraddha*. The Sarvodaya ideal of sacrifice is both *Tatva-Tyagam* and *Dhana-Tyagam* which denotes the involuntary surrender of man and his possessions. Charity is more a self-purity than social aid. It is a chaste act which aims at social righteousness *Samajik-Swadharma*.⁶³ The social imperatives and the social incentives are at race in the sacred social ideology of Dan. The generous act of the giver involves an individual imperative and the curious acknowledgement of the receiver involves a social incentive. Thus the concept

62. *Satyagraha* is one of the most powerful mediums of social transformation in Gandhian ideology. It aims at conquering the adversary without causing any suffering to him. Far and above it involves individual suffering. *Satyagraha* indeed means a conscious suffering of the individual in pursuit of truth. *Satyagraha* never means a meak and weak submission of the rights of the individual but it is a sign of protest based on Truth and Justice. A Sarvodayi may become a satyagrahi for a noble cause and a satyagrahi may try to become a sarvodayi through a process of realisation. *Satyagraha* has been the sole instrument with Gandhi. *Satyagraha* thus means a non-violent resistance to evil. Literally it means clinging to truth.

63. Sympathy, Charity, kindness and goodness based on sacrifice is the content of social righteousness. There are several social ailments on planes economic, social, moral and spiritual. To discover all such ailments and dispense some cures to them is the sole purpose of social reformer. The right reformation of society is the *Sadharna-dharma* of a Sarvodayi.

of social gift, charity and philanthropy is deemed always as a dynamic social ideal. Marx,⁶⁴ the material philosopher encouraged class-consciousness, amplified class-conflict and thus tilted the social equilibrium in the past. On the other hand Acharya Vinoba Bhave inspired the masses to adopt a higher life of renunciation and detachment. The detachment according to Sarvodaya is the detachment of the Ego, a life of selfless action and dedication. The creation of *Shanti-Sena*⁶⁵ or Peace Bridge to promote world-peace and human harmony through mutual love and good-will is indeed an ideal achievement of Sarvodaya. One of the most common social devices of Sarvodaya include *Nishta-Patra*⁶⁶ or Sarvodaya Patra. The slow and gradual conditioning of human sympathy and the incessant and latent realisation of social responsibility form the cardinal truths of Sarvodaya Patra. The social realism of Sarvodaya ideology envisages, the creation of *Krishi-Samitis*⁶⁷ or work councils as necessary accompaniments to social progress. The mental and physical values of work should be well approximated in order to evolve an authentic self-hood of man.

The concept of society has been the talk of innumerable social and academic thinkers of the past. Rousseau⁶⁸ pleaded for the labouring and peasant class and demanded an early deliverance from social bondage. Earlier, Hobbes⁶⁹ state of nature supposed a state of peace, good will and mutual assistance much apart from its state of war. The social philosophy of the Epicureans⁷⁰ was based upon the

64. Karl Marx was the 18th century dialectical Materialist who moved the world for more than a century. He published the famous Communist Mani-

festos with Engels and after 20 years, his first volume of *Das Capital* appeared. The philosophical aspect of Marxism is widely known as dialectical Materialism. Historical Materialism teaches that primitive society was classless and when the classes arose some special institutions of coercion like State were created by the ruling classes. The social theory of Marxism centers around the class character of society. In Economics it maintains a labour theory of value which involves the concept of surplus value in the capitalistic mode of production. Upon the basis of its analysis of Capitalism, Marxism erects the ethical conclusion on that Capitalism is unjust and ought to be supplemented by Socialism.

65. It was in the year 1938 that the idea of *Shanti-sena* struck Gandhiji for the first time although it was quite obvious that he had been a *Shanti-Sainik* all his life. On similar lines Vinoba is striving to build a new society in his life-time, free from individual fear, class-coercion and social exploitation. The object of *Peace Brigade* is to work at times of tension and serve as a revolutionary constructive unit at all other times. This is the traditional interpretation of the significance of *Shanti-Sena*. But the real role of *Shanti-Sena* transcends all the common limitations of social exigency and social harmony as much as it is considered as an inevitable and integral reality of human evolution and survival. Peace at all cost and even peace at any cost is the sole aim of *Shanti-Sena*. The main weapon of *Shanti-Sena* is power of love.

66. Vinoba expects every household to maintain a small pot or a vessel. Everyday the youngest of the lot should add a handful of rice or grain either in the morning or in the evening. After weeks collection the container should be taken out and the proceeds therein be given to the *Shanti-Sena*-workers. This is indeed a sign of willingness of the people for a peace.

ful order of society and therein implied unwillingness to be a party to any form of conflict whatsoever. Sarvodaya Patra is more or less an individual realisation than a social good or transformation. 'Gifts should be given with faith; they should never be given without faith. Gifts should be given in plenty, with modesty and with sympathy.' Vide *Taittiriya Upanishad* Chapter 1—*Sikshavalli*.

67. Our ancient tradition or *smriti* stressed on the aspect of consecrated work based on collective effort. Work-councils envisaged by Sarvodaya imply both Voluntarism and Collectivism. This is indeed considered as one of the basic achievements of Sarvodaya in modern times. If such work-councils function particularly in places where Sarvodaya Samaj has started some demonstrative farms of production, the ideal of *Shosana-Vihina-Samaj* can easily be materialised without any contradiction in the present policies of *Gramodyog* laid down by Sarvodaya. Activism is never antagonistic to any forms of either altruism or spiritualism. Spiritual activity is the essence of reality particularly in India. However, the concept of pure act, i.e., *actus-purus* can be traced to Aristotle's Conception of Divinity. In Sankara's commentary on 'Gita' we come across two words, *Pravrtti* and *Nivrtti*. *Pravrtti* is activism and *Nivrtti* is asceticism. There is a common saying which goes that activism is the ideal of *grahasta* and *asceticism* is the ideal of *samnyasa*. However, in real sense we cannot draw the strict line of demarcation between action and in-action in higher dimensions of thought. *Hirayana* cites the example of King Aja of Raghuvamsa, a classic written by Kalidasa, the immortal poet of India. King Aja was an ideal blend of both *grahasta* and *samnyasa*. The names of Rama, Krishna, Narada, Gandhi and Vinoba cannot, however, be overlooked in this context who ideally represented both the life of an ascetic and activist.

68. Jean Jacques Rousseau a native of Geneva moved not only France but the whole of Europe with his enormous influence for many a decade. He was an 18th century political thinker and a writer of wide eminence. His *Emile* is a revolutionary treatise espousing the cause of natural education against the doctrines of formal education; his social contract is considered as the most significant contribution to political thought as the creative and *collective will* of the people and his criticisms of the degeneracy of the contemporary culture made him one of the most daring reformers of the French Society.

69. Hobbes was an English Materialist Philosopher who lived in the later part of the 15th century. He proposed a materialistic approach to all problems of human nature, society and politics, based solely on the mechanics of motion. Hobbes denied free-will theory out-and-out and considered knowledge as empirical in its origin and results. *On Man* and *Leviathan* are his works.

70. Epeureans are a group of Hedonistic philosophers of Greece lead by Epicurus the founder of Epeureanism in whom include Democritus the Athenian writer, Lucretius the Roman poet. These were considered as the fore-runners of medieval nominalism and modern empiricism. Due to its anti-mystical traditional tendency Epeureanism soon became a potential rival to all forms of Platonism, Stoicism and peripatetism. All Epeureans based morality on pleasure. Pleasure according to them is the ultimate goal based on natural instinct. Epeureans propagated widely the doctrine of enlightened self-interest. Epicurus exhorted prudence in the pursuit of pleasure. Social contract is the origin of society with almost all Epeureans. Epeureans resemble in most respects with *Sushikshita Carvakas* of Indian philosophy.

principle of self-interest and the principle of self-protection apart from the life of pleasure and enjoyment. According to Comte⁷¹ social life is not based upon self-interest but it originates from social-impulse. The altruistic impulses of man dominate his egoistic pursuits.

The social concept of man and the communitarian ideal of society was also dealt by many a leading philosopher and social thinker of the past. For example, the concept of man and the social ideal preached by Hegel⁷² was different from others altogether. In Hegel's society the individual and his subjective conscience is subordinated

71. Comte was the French Philosopher of the 18th century who revolted against the social efficacy of *Utopianism* and formulated his own social philosophy called Social physics or positivism. The history of humanity according to him should be described in terms of three stages. The first is the theological stage when people's interpretation of reality was dominated by faith, the second metaphysical stage when people attempted to comprehend about reality but unable to support their contention by facts and the third stage was positive when dogmatic assumptions began to be replaced by factual knowledge. Sarvodaya is idealistic, positivistic and altruistic in its application. Thus it is viewed as synthetic philosophy.

72. Hegel was a German philosopher of the mid 18th century who constructed the dominant metaphysical system. He believed in a world-soul, the *Absolute*, comprehensible only through a method of cognition and reasoning and called it dialectics based on thesis, anti-thesis and synthesis. The dialectical materialism of Marx with its economic interpretation of history is also considered as the off-shoot of the Hegelianism.

to Universal Reason. The *Republic* of Plato⁷³ states that the individual cannot attain the good in-isolation but only in society. The individual should subordinate his private interests to the public good. According to Aristotle⁷⁴ Moral society begets moral action. The social environment conducive to moral growth can alone think of an Ideal society. In the recent years, Mahatma Gandhi⁷⁵ in India preached a social life which can tally with one's own moral existence. The ends of the society are no-where except in its means. In the contemporary period Acharya Vinoba Bhave gave a new outlook to society i.e., *Shoshana-Vihina-Samaj*. The social gains and the individual gains are inseparable entities in Sarvodaya philosophy. There is both an instantaneous and simultaneous growth of the individual and the society in a single ideal act of social good. There is a contemporaneous process, a process of individual realisation and a process of social evolution.

The *Lokayatika* ideals of *Carvaka*⁷⁶ philosophy preached an ideal of world-unity based on the metaphysics of matter. The *Mahayana* ideals of Buddhism advocated a unified ideal of world-unity based on the Ethics of social reality. On the other hand the Sarvodaya as a recent tendency in social and moral philosophy tends to preach a

73. The most famous of early Greek philosophers, plato was the desciple of Socrates and the teacher of Aristotle. His theory of Ideas is highly metaphysical. Ideas or Archetypes are reals and universals. The objects are not reals. On the other hand they are copies of Ideas. The highest idea according to plato is the idea of Good which he places at the apex of his heirarchy of Ideas. 'Men may come and men may go but the man-type is eternal' was his main dictum.

Plato's *Republic* is the picture of ideal state, the dream of society embodying the principle of Justice.

74. Aristotle was the first philosopher of Greece to construct an idealistic philosophy on same systematic lines. He worked for 20 long years in Plato's Academy working both as a teacher and as a student. After the death of Plato he started his own school at Athens called as the *peripatetic school*. This was named so because Aristotle had a habit of talking while giving instructions to his pupils. He was a potential and a universal genius. Aristotle in his *polemic* criticised Plato's theory of Ideas. Virtue according to Aristotle is a kind of moderation because it aims at a Mean avoiding two extremes i.e., *madhyamika-marga*. The *Nichomachean Ethics* of Aristotle contains books on 'Friendship' and 'Justice.'

75. Gandhi is popularly called as the Father of the Nation in India. He was the freedom fighter against the British colonial rule. So, author of non-violent-resistance, civil disobedience and *satyagraha*. He pleaded for the adoption of spinning wheel as a symbolic protest against the commercial interests of the British as early as 1920. Indians consider him not only as a *Mahatma* i.e., the "great soul" but even as an *Avatar* or incarnation in their heights of real love and admiration for him. Acharya Vinoba Bhave is the living and moving shadow of Mahatma Gandhi in modern times.

76. Charvakas are considered to be Indian materialists materialism is a metaphysical doctrine which denotes that matter alone is real and all other substances other than matter are unreal. According to Charvaka philosophy *Pratyaksa* is the only *pramana* or dependable source of knowledge. All non-perceptible realities or entities like life before death and after death, soul and God, *Karma* and *adrishta* are unreal. Only *artha* or wealth and *karma* or pleasure are to be pursued. Eat, drink and be merry are watch-words of Carvaka theory.

humanitarian metaphysik⁷ which is mostly based on the two main generic and divergent ideals of partiality or particularity and impartiality or generality, i.e., *Paksha-Rahita* and *Paksha-Atita* in modern times. The social concept of Sarvodaya thus transcends all social limitations of the age. The sole medium of Sarvodaya social transformation is 'Love.' Through love of individual alone man can thrive in this world. The Sarvodaya ideal of human unity is based more upon the *Ethik* of social morality rather than on metaphysics of reality. The idea of the welfare of all engenders a new social outlook of morality. The social ideal of man is not indifferent to his moral and spiritual ideals. On the other hand the basic pursuit of man is based upon a synthetic social ideal according to Sarvodaya. Thus, the social ideal of Sarvodaya is not only ever-expanding but it is ever-emanating and so ever-inspiring to us. The universal social ideal of Sarvodaya Samaj is fast tending to establish a universal social order, more particularly from the dawn of the later half of this century. It is no wonder if it succeeds in bringing about a superior life, upon this superannuated Earth.⁷⁸

Sarvodaya democracy is against all forms of organisational hierarchy. In a Sarvodaya democracy the ethics of the ruler is identified with the ethos of the people. The egalitarian outlook of Sarvodaya is *Samya-Yoga*.⁷⁹ The

77. The word used is a complex combination of two dynamic concepts i.e., the ideal of man and his dilectical pursuit. What is the science of the being of man? and what are its first principles? etc., are all primarily dealt in Humanitarian metaphysics. All the inadequacies and inaccuracies of thought are however eliminated from the scheme of human affairs to give rise to a systematic philosophy of man.

78. The earth which is declared as too old for continuance and sustenance may become once again a haunting place of glory if all the sublime ideals of sarvodaya are implanted in the hearts of the individuals. The anti-metaphysical attitude, that life is not worth living, that world is full of suffering and that the earth is superannuated has no meaning when the kingdom of heaven dawns upon this earth through Sarvodaya.

79. The society based on *Samyayoga* is the society of the poorest and lowliest and the last. But, lowliest and the last feel as the highest and the richest. *Samyayogi society* disregards however the age-old laws of economics, out-dated rules of society and worn-out and stagnant set-up of the age which do not behove the dignity of modern man. On the other hand the socio-economic orientation, decentralised state democracy, new national education, noetic ethical and moral values and inter-continental world citizenship etc., are some of the hall-marks of new society. Above all, conversion and not coercion is the sole medium of social transformation. There is no difference between man and man. The aggressive power of love will neutralise and subdue the partisan and conflicting spirit. A *Samya-yogi* sees with equal emphasis everything in the image of his own self. When he desires good to himself he desires good to all. This aspect is called as *Atma-aupamyā*. *Samya-vada* is different from *Samya-yoga*. *Samya-yoga* is a sort of equalisation, harmonisation and divinisation. On the other hand *Samya-vada* is a sort of egalitarianism and communitarianism. *Samya-yoga* includes *Samya-vada* but *Samya-vada* never includes *Samya-yoga*. *Samya-yoga* is the whole and *Samya-vada* is its partial concept. However, both these concepts rest on *Samanvaya* or integration. *Samya-yoga* envisages a higher human integration while *Samya-vada* brings about *Sadharna-Samanvaya* or ordinary human integration. *Samya-Dharma* is the creed of Sarvodaya.

equality-ideals were preached by several communitarian polities but they differ both in degree and in quality. For instance the equality-ideals of Communism are confined to *Samya-vada*. On the other hand the egalitarian principles of Sarvodaya are represented through *Samya-Dharma*. The collective form of spiritual effort of man is *Samoochik-Sadhana*⁸⁰ in Sarvodaya. The Sarvodaya is a form of *Gramodyoga*⁸¹ or a sort of back to the village movement. The Sarvodaya *Sainik* or the soldier of Sarvodaya takes the sword of *Samanvaya* or integration from the armoury of Sarvodaya democracy and fights for the cause of *Antah-Suddhi* or internal purity of the masses. Non-

80. *Samagra-seva* or overall service to humanity is the *Samoochik-Sadhana* or over-all effort of *Shoshana-Vihina-Samaj*. Sarvodaya effort is both apparent and transparent, collective and collateral, cohesive and regulative, and above all effectual and spiritual. When Sarvodaya can be called as *Siddhi-yoga* it invariably involves *Sadhana* apart from worship of work.

81. Sarvodaya being an integral philosophy aims at both individual realisation and social evolution. For individual realisation, certain amount of *Tapasya* is needed and for social evolution some *Tyaga* is necessary. Thus in this sense real *Samaja-seva* becomes a spiritual effort or *Sadhana*. It involves both *Atma-suddhi* and *Lokaniti*. *Swartha* or self-interest is sacrificed at the alter of *Paramartha* or social interest. Social service will no more be considered as an individual obligation but a birth-right of the people. This is indeed the new society of Sarvodaya.

ethless, he dedicates all his worldly pleasures and achievements *Samarpana* for the cause of total-welfare of man. The total consent of all *Sammati* for the over-all concord of all *Shanti* is the Ideal of Sarvodaya. The unity of mind with action based on *Prapatti*, Surrender to God is the all-arising and ever-inspiring goal of Sarvodaya Samaj.

CHAPTER IV

THE MORAL ASPECT OF SARVODAYA

The moral aspect of Sarvodaya includes both *Atma-Bodha* and *Samaja-Seva*. There is in the moral life of man a certain moral ideal and the real importance of his life lies in the wilful pursuit of this ideal. This ideal of man ever-recedes from him as he proceeds towards it. The ever-evolving individual conscious states of man and his ever-emanating collective moral ideals are eternal co-realities. This moral consciousness of man evokes a moral force. The *Anandamaya-Atma*⁸² of a moral man tends to give rise to an austerity which is based on *Anasakti-yoga*⁸³ or the sense of non-attachment. Thus, moral life is regarded by all as a process of continuous development. Gandhian morality is the very foundation of life. The existence and the progress of man depends upon the moral self of man.

82. Man by virtue of his primal ignorance or *avidya* identifies himself with the material sheaths which tend to cover his real self or soul. *Taittiriya-Upanishad* describes five *kosas* or sheaths of the soul of man which symbolise his primeval ignorance or *avidya*. The first two material sheaths which cover the real self or soul of man are considered as *Anna-maya-kosa* and *Prana-maya-kosa*. The first is the product of gross matter and the latter is made up of breath inside the body. The *Mano-maya-kosa* is the third and the *Vijnana-maya-kosa* is the fourth sheath of the soul. *Mano-maya-kosa* or the mind is some-

times represented in terms of four *Samhitas* and *Brahmanas*. This is absolute moral code according to the teachings of *Upanishads*. On the other hand *Vijnana-maya-kosa* or intuitive reason is expressed in terms of *Sat* or truth and *dharma* or righteousness. This is absolute ethical conduct according to the teachings of *Upanishads*. *Vijnana-maya-kosa* is further interpreted in terms of *Sraddha* or faith, *rita* or the purity of thought and *satya* or the purity of deed. The last layer is called *Ananda-maya-kosa* which is the final-stage or realisation of the real joy or bliss. All the five are also explained in terms of Gross body, Sub-Conscious, Conscious, and Self-conscious existences of man. The last one i.e., *Ananda-maya-kosa* is indicated as the higher grade of existence based on the True and the Holy...Vide *Taittiriya-Upanishad*.

83 .The whole of Gandhian morality centres around *Anasakti-yoga*. It is the *yoga* of detachment preached by Gita, interpreted by Gandhi as the sole medium of realisation. The ancient saints and sages of India practised *anasakti* or detachment which has become the message of Gita for generations to follow. However, the feeling of detachment, the sense of selfless service and the mind for dedicated work are embodied in human nature, provided they are given proper facilities for their spontaneous growth. This is possible only through practice of disciplined action or *Yoga*. *Vairagya* is the feeling of dis-satisfaction, a detachment from interest. *Samnyasa*, on the other hand implies renunciation instead of abnegation. One who is still in the process of striving to realise is called *Vividisa-samnyasa* and who has already realised one's purpose is called *Vidvat-Samnyasa*. *Yoga* is again different from *Vairagya* and *Samnyasa*. *Yoga* is not restraining of the sense and concentration of the mind as it is usually stated, but a *citta-Vrttinirodha* i.e., disciplining the activities of our consciousness. In Indian philosophy about 12 major *yogas* are elicited. *Ashtyog*,

Morality is both an ideal and a way of life in Gandhian ideology. On the other hand the moral being and the moral ideal are never two separate entities in Sarvodaya ideology. Acharya Vinoba Bhave on some other occasion differentiates between social morality and individual morality. *Tapasya* is individual morality and *Tyaga* is social morality. The material is moral and the moral is Spiritual in Sarvodaya⁸⁴ Moral revulsion against crime is an out-dated concept in Sarvodaya. On the other hand it preaches a sense of moral optimism. The mental house-hold of man should never be untidy.

Hatha-yog, Laya-yog Raj-yog; mantra-yog, dhyan-yog, bhakti-yog, gnya-yog, karma-yog, shadbh-yog, the yoga of yog-vashishta and the yoga of Advaita-vedanta etc., and again the yoga of Bhagvat-geeta is interpreted in diverse ways, as Arjuna-vishada-yoga, Sankhya-yoga, karma-yoga, Jnana-vibhaga-yoga, karma-sannyasa-yoga, Adhyatma-yoga, Jnana-yoga, Akshara-Brahma-yoga, Raja-Vidya-Raja-Guhya-yoga, Vibhuti-yoga Vishva-rupa-darshana-yoga, bhakti-yoga, Kshetra-Kshetrajna-vibhaga-yoga, Guna-traya-vibhaga-yoga, Purushottama-yoga, Daivasura-sampad-vibhaga-yoga, Sharaddha-traya-vibhaga-yoga and Samnyasa-yoga ... Vide. Mundaka Upanishad.

84. Sarvodaya morality is not only based on essential moral or *Niti* and eternal creed or *Niyam* but also *Tyaga* and *Tapasya*. The essential values undergo inter-penetration for higher and higher evolution in Sarvodaya. For instance the higher physical is the lesser moral and the higher moral is the lesser spiritual and likewise spiritual is considered as the eternal and the universal Ideal of Humanity. This atypical inter-penetration of different values is characterised in a crude sense as *anarchy of values* in western theory of value.

Care should be taken always to keep it clean and serene. Sarvodaya distinguishes between the lower and the higher nature of man. The transformation of the lower nature into the higher one forms one of the main objectives i.e., *Niam*. Sarvodaya is wedded to Conscience theory⁸⁵ of morality instead of social theory. The collective conscience is the total divine according to Sarvodaya maxim of morality. In this way Sarvodaya tends to construct a model thesis of morality which would satisfy people of all levels of mental evolution.

85. There is no philosophy whatsoever without morality. Different philosophers interpreted morality in different ways. But categorically speaking all roads lead but to Rome. Bergson's *Two sources of Morality* is an anti-thesis between intellect and intuition. It isolates creative morality based on moral insight from the social morality which implies social obligation of the individual. On the other hand, the genius of Fichte demanded the freedom of moral law from the rule of sense. According to Fichte conscience commands duty for duty's sake. It enters into one long continuous struggle with the life of sense. Thus, the conscience theory of morality of Fichte implies individual morality of a very high order. The social morality is however expansive and progressively propagative compared with the qualitative morality of the individual. 'The example of Alexander's continence has not made so many converts to chastity, as that of his drunkenness has to intemperance. Men apprehend no shame in being less perfect than he, and judge it very excusable to be more defective. We are apt to think ourselves much above the corruptions of the vulgar when we fall into the vices of these great and renowned persons.' Vide. *Pascal's 'Thoughts on Religion.'*

Kant's Metaphysics⁸⁶ of morals is a clear testimony of his moral philosophy. That act which is based on inclination is not a real act. On the other hand the respect for the law is the main object of morality. Again, obedience to moral law does not guarantee human happiness.

Moral law according to Fichte⁸⁷ is based upon religious faith. *Will-to-believe* was his main ambition. On the other hand Acharya Vinoba Bhave indicates his implicit faith in *will-to-work* in his concept of morality. Moral conscience of man is the real mirror of his deeds. Fichte pleaded for a moral community created by the members of the community themselves.

86. The 'Foundations of metaphysics of Morality' of Kant clearly indicates a Moral Imperative which is not only considered by him as the genuine expression of man's inner self but a real principle of his being. Moral law is a categorical imperative. Kant rejects all persistent forms of morality as orthodox, utilitarian, sentimental and conditional. An isolated act performed on the basis of sheer impulse is the real act of morality. Sympathy, inclination and self love has no place whatsoever in the scheme of Kantian morality. Kantian Ethics is criticised as formalistic and rigoristic.

87. Fichte was a German idealist philosopher who lived in the early part of the 18th century and believed that the world is an arena of action in which man realises his moral duty. Fichte for some time served as the romantic leader of the German nationalist movement against the French occupation and engaged himself wholly in arousing the German youth against Napoleonic wars. He held that 'Will' or Ego is the primary principle behind all civilization and progress.

In the philosophy of Aristotle⁸ we find, that the function of the soul itself is a moral virtue and the perfect action based on reason is called *dianoetic virtue*. The Sarvodaya morality never isolates moral virtue from the other intellectual virtues. There cannot be any real and the ideal intellect without its live-roots in the subjective knowledge of other men. 'The virtuous man will act often in the interest of his friends and of his country and if need be will even die for them.'

Bergson's⁸⁹ 'Two sources of morality and Religion' differentiates between two types of morality. The first type of morality is rooted in the needs of society and the second type of morality is the expression of man's genius and insight as a voluntary act of goodness and kindness towards others. The latter is the creative morality. In the same

88. The disciple of Plato who started the peripatetic school in Athens and advocated the philosophy of *Golden Mean*. Virtue is a kind of moderation. It is a happy Mean between two extremes of avarice and extravagance. Aristotle's philosophy is more systematic than any of the early Greek philosophers. It is more or less an encyclopaedia of facts and so considered as the distillation of Greek thought.

89. 19th century anti-mechanist and the most influential among the pioneers of spiritualistic metaphysics in modern times. His vitalistic doctrines centre round *Elan Vital* a phrase which sums up his entire evolutionary philosophy. The ideal of science according to Bergson is the incomplete ideal which mechanises all. Intuition not Reason as a spiritualised instinct is nearer to life and consciousness. Our knowledge should be based on the direct vision of Reality says Bergson.

way Sarvodaya presents a basic morality, a morality which is rooted in humanity itself. That the good of the individual is contained in the good of all and that the social consciousness in action can bring about a secular social revolution as Bhoodan.⁹⁰ Bhoodan tends to illumine the social penumbra of the people. While Marx taught the doctrine of class-morality to the people of his age, Vinoba Bhave gave the creative and useful ideals of human and universal morality to the people of this age. The Central tendency of Sarvodaya thought is directed towards all aspects of life. It insists upon a philosophy of life based on life for life.⁹¹ The insistence of Sarvodaya on self-purity through *Yoga*⁹² is indeed a unique contribution to modern social and moral thought. That the ultimate ideal of man⁹³ is to perfect himself with a sole view of perfecting the world, forms the cardinal belief of Sarvodaya worker. The need for universal unity of all and that our moral and religious duties are towards all etc., is deeply felt by Sarvodaya.

90. According to Vinoba mere giving away land by land-owners to the landless is not sufficient cause but it is an encouraging sign of social philosophy. Bhoodan is transference of some lands from the rich to the poor, but it never means the abolition of private ownership of land. Land can only be the property of the entire society. If people according to Vinoba realise this fact it would invariably amount to the *poornata* or completeness of Bhoodan *yagna*. Vinoba prefers substituting the other word *Bhookranti* to signify the collective pledge of the people, to rouse people's consciousness towards sense of justice by generating the creative power of peace and by fostering the compassionate love of brotherhood among the various human communities.

91. Life is not a mere condition of motion, a duration, a journey and an activity of the self but it

Gandhi exclaimed once and said that "Hate the Sin and not the Sinner." Christ said in the past "Heal thyself before healing others." The moral ideal of Sarvodaya seems to have integrated the content of both and so goes to

is a meaningful mission of Love, and Peace. The book of life begins with love. We must hope to live than to live merely. Live while you live should be our slogan. Life is not an idle dream in Sarvodaya. Sarvodaya lives in deeds and not in years. He counts time by his heart-throbs. He gives his life to save other's life not as his boundened duty but he loves other's life much more than his life. Thus, love is an ennobling longing of life in ideal Sarvodaya Samaj. There are many interpretations of love as there are many ways of love. Love as *Eros* of Platonics, love as *Agape* of chistian mystics, intellectual Love of Spinoza, compassionate love of Gautam Buddha and the exalted love of Rama-krishna are but one and the same apparition of Life. Thus, the self-identity of life with love is a magnificent reality in Sarvodaya.

92. Yoga implies both *Citta* and *Atma-shuddhi* and also *Samoochik Sadhana*. Yoga is *atma-jnana* as much as *samaja-seva*. Yoga is also *yagna* as much as *darsana*. A *yogi* or *sannyasi* will sit in an undisturbed place resting in a comfortable posture clean and pure with neck, head and body in one line held erect in a mental attitude of an ascetic having controlled all his senses, saluting ones own teacher mentally with reverence and meditate within the lotus of his heart, the pure the untainted the clear and griefless state of existence'. Vide *Kaivalyopanishad Part 1-(5)*.

93. In *Advaita-vedanta* of Sankara we are drawr to the ultimate goal of life. We are forced to shed all our *raga* or narrow love and *dvesa* or hatred in the eternal and abiding peace of *Brahman*. The all-comprehensive love of God is the key to all happiness.

say in its *Upa-Samhara* or Conclusion that "rights follow the duties." This can however be considered as *Pragna-Purani*⁷⁴ or the wisdom of the ages particularly in India.

94. India is known for its glorious past. Many great men are born, made and moved history from generation to generation. Asoka and Buddha, Ramakrishna and Vivekananda, Shankara and Ramanuja, Gandhi and Vinoba all come under one category of men who with their ethical and moral talents enriched the glory of our great country. But, if we view them in the context of their creative contributions made, we come to a conclusion that they not only represented India but represented the entire age or *yuga* to which they belonged. The celestial Gods, human beings and the demonic creatures were considered to be the descendants of *Prajapati* the Lord of creation. They were called as *Devas*, *Manavas* and *Asuras* respectively and all lived as descendants of *Prajapati*. Each of the above beseeched the Lord to teach them. The Lord uttered the syllable *Da* every time and questioned his descendants whether they could follow. All of them answered that they could follow the meaning of *Da* in their own way. According to Gods, *Da* is *Damayata* i.e., be self-controlled, *Datta* or be charitable according to men and according to Demons, *Da* is *Dayadhwam* or be compassionate. Vide. *Brihadaranyako Upanishad-Yagnavalka*.

CHAPTER V

THE ETHICAL ASPECT OF SARVODAYA

The ethical aspect of Sarvodaya is called *Yogashastra*.⁹⁵ The Cyrenaics⁶ and the Epicureans⁷ pursued the greatest happiness of life as a whole. This theory however presented a repulsive attitude towards moral consciousness. The objective content was never considered useful over subjective pleasure. The Utilitarians held high the idea of the greatest good of the greatest numbers. The

95. The attempt of Sarvodaya to construct an ethical philosophy on the basis of *Yagna* or sacrifice culminates in *yoga-shastra*. The *Siddhi-yog* of *sarvodaya* aims at the wisdom state of existence of man i.e., *Sthita-pragna*. *Swabhava* or the law of human nature not only contradicts sometimes with *swartha* or selfish interests of man but even aims at a higher human effort i.e., *purushartha*. Of all the *Yagnas*, *karma-yagna* or sacrifice through action assumes primary importance in Sarvodaya. The *summum bonum* of life is in the nature of inner offering of the individual self to social self and purpose behind all such superior *yagna* or sacrifice is *Mukti* or liberation of the real social existence of man from the quagmire of human profligacy, and divine depravity and predestination. Thus, Sarvodaya presents an ethical *world-view* which is neither based on the moderation of impulse nor freedom from sense but purely on the purification of soul and aspiration of the Divine./

96. A School of Greek philosophy founded by Aristippus of Cyrene in 380 B.C. The main doctrines

general happiness was regarded as superior to individual happiness. In the later ages the thorough-going ethical system of the Utilitarians became obsolete mostly due to internal contradictions. Peter Abilard⁹⁸ the 12th century school man emphasised the *ethik* of the individual and said that God considers not what is done, but in what spirit it is done. St. Thomas Aquinas⁹⁹ the 12th century Scholastic

of this school are that life is full of pleasures, that we should fully enjoy these pleasures and that the contentment of life lies in the fulfilment of desires. Education is necessary so as to guide one to proper enjoyment. One should learn to be the master of pleasures and not its slave. The greatest pleasure was the greatest good with cyrenaics. Its ethics is hedonistic nearer to that of Epecureans in the west and Carvakas in the East.

97. Epecureans were the members of the Athenian School of Philosophy that bears the name Epecurianism after Epicurus its first founder round about 306 B.C. The absence of pain and repose of the mind were the main doctrines of Epecurean Ethics. That pleasure and happiness is the natural end of life. Epecureanism became a doctrine of enlightened self-interest and so soon became a rival to all forms of Platonism, Peripatetism and Stoicism.

98. Peter Abailard was born in France, in 11th century and taught philosophy with much emphasis on dialectics. He lectured on theology in Paris when he was involved in the romantic interlude with Heloise. Abailard is known as a brilliant theologian of his times.

99. St. Thomas aquinas was born at Aquino in 1225; taught by Benedictine monks in a monastery he later became the pupil of Albert the Great. God according to St. Thomas is the first and the final cause

agreed with Aristotle in his ethical interpretation that *beatitudo* or blessedness consists in self-realisation. Supernatural good was his ultimate ambition. Human conduct is governed by the eternal or divine law *Lex aeterna*. Besides eternal or divine law there is also natural or human law *Lex natura*,—the law which is written in our inner hearts. Thus, an ethical act is governed both by the natural law and the Divine Law. The highest ethical good according to Aristotle is *Eudaimonia*. Every virtuous activity is accompanied by virtuous pleasure. Pleasure is not an ideal but a necessary *corollary* to virtue says Aristotle. The supreme goal of human conduct is religion; and the earthly life is but a pilgrimage to God says St. Augustine.¹⁰ Kantian ethics is based on the Categorical Imperative which is universal and *apriori*. Plato provides a comprehensive world-view in his ethical theory based on the highest good

of the universe. We infer the existence of God from his creation. St. Thomas rejects the Ontological argument of God of St. Anselm and attempts to prove that God is the cause of all causes i.e., *Causa Sui*—Cosmological argument.

100. St. Augustine of Hippo was the greatest teacher of the early Christian Church. The only knowledge worth acquiring is the knowledge of God. The highest perfection is transcendental good and the relative perfection is a kind of holiness. He became a convert at the age of 33 after hearing the sermons of Ambrose the Bishop of Milan. 'City of God' is his popular work and his 'confessions' reveal the early account of his life.

which is identical with God. Schopenhauer¹⁰¹ teaches an ethics based on sympathy which he considers as the standard of morality. The central thesis of Socratic¹⁰² ethics is contained in the formula no man is voluntarily bad or involuntarily good.' Socrates further says in 'Apology' that 'virtue is not given by money, but that from virtue comes money and every other good of man, public as well as private.'

101. Arther Schopenhauer was a many sided philosopher of 18th century. He refuted all forms of materialism and subjectivism in his principle work, 'The world as will and Idea.' Schopenhauer upholds the ideal of Buddha. That desire is the cause of pain, and that by relinquishing all desires man can allay his will and attain perfection. His philosophy is commonly intepreted in terms of Pessimism. The *thing-in-itself* is the only reality. Ascetic ideal is the only ideal through which we can realise the reality are some of his reflections.

102. Socrates is considered as one of the greatest philosophers of the early Greek period. He was married to Xanthippe who had a very wide reputation of being a terrible scold. He was the teacher of Plato. He visited public places, used to stand at the cross-roads, put anti-thetical questions to people, professed his initial ignorance and finally he would prawn upon the opponent and convince him of his own argument. In this way he made many enemies than friends. Finally, he was accused of impiety on the basis of three major charges of denying the national Gods, putting Gods of his own and corrupting the Athenian youth. Being condemned by a narrow majority of the judges, Socrates was sentenced to death by drinking hemlock. He wrote nothing, yet he is known fully through the writings of Aristophanes particularly through his 'clouds,' Xenophons' imperfect account and mostly through the dialogues of Plato.

Protagoras¹⁰³ the Sophist said that 'man is the measure of all. The concept of Vaihinger's¹⁰⁴ ethics is a 'Practical fiction.' The ethical ideal according to Vaihinger is the ideational construct with full of conflicting realities both from within and without. Above all it has an inviolable and irresistible power. On the other hand, the ethology of Sarvodaya is based on Social reality as much as upon Individual morality. The word *Yagna* or sacrifice is the central thread of the ethics of Gita. Sacrifice is the basis of life. Further the *Karma-yagna* or the sacrifice through action is the superior form of *Yagna* in Gita.¹⁰⁵ The Jaina ethics^{1 6} is based

103. Protagoras of Abdera was a leading sophist of the 4th century B.C. 'That man is the measure of all things' is indicative of his high ethical doctrines. Sophists were wandering teachers who came to Athens and sought to popularise scientific knowledge. They trained the Athenian youth in rhetoric and in the art of conversation.

104. Hans Vaihinger's philosophy is similar in many of its doctrines to American Pragmatism. He preached the philosophy of 'as if.' He considers that all concepts used in mathematics, social and theoretical sciences are convenient fictions. Moral ideals are the products of the great and noble minds of history to which the whole of humanity clings and thus guided by their impact. Fictionalism is an extreme form of pragmatism.

105. He who discovers *Akarma* or inaction in *Karma* or action and vice-versa is considered as a wise man among men; a seer and a perfect being who is all in all and has done all he need do. According to Vinoba's 'Talks on Gita,' *Karma* is a concrete action performed as *Swadharmā*. *Vikarma* is the active participation of *Chitta* or mind in the external action. that is, *Karma*; and *Akarma* is the voluntary approxi-

mation of both, that is, *Karma* and *Vikarma*. God alone is wholly responsible for all actions. Since all actions proceed from Him, no mortal can claim for himself any action. Ramanuja even equates *Akarma* with *Atama-Jnana*. Vide *Gita* 4-(18). There are many forms of *yagnas* right from the sacrifice of material riches to the ultimate surrender of self in *Gita*. *Karma-yagna* or sacrifice through action is considered as one of the significant acts. 'The fruits of *karma-yagna* lies in the realisation of the various *karmanas* found in the *mantras* which were however practised in *Treta-yuga* or in the age of three *vedas*. Practice them always with true wishes. This is the only way for us all to attain the fruits of *Karma-yagna*, Vide. *Mundaka Upanishad* Chapter 1-2 (1).

106. Mahavira, the 6th century religious teacher is considered as the last of the great teachers of Jainism. Tirthankars were 24 in number, Malleseena, Parsawantha and Vardhamana were considered to be the last three. Jainism is a sort of pluralistic realism. Jaina Ethics is characterised by *Tri-ratna* and *Pancha-maha-vratas*. *Tri-ratna* are three gems of Jainism and *Pancha-maha-vratas* are considered as five great vows of Jainism. The good life consists in the acquisition of the three gems of right faith, right conduct and right knowledge. Again right conduct is chisselled and modelled by five great vows of *Satyam*, *Asteyam*, *Ahimsa*, *Brahmacharyanam* and *Aparigraha*. Jaina then becomes a *Kevala-Jnani* or the pure and perfect knower. A *Kevala-Jnani* is also a *para-jnani*. Angiras says to Sownaka the great house-holder in *Mundaka Upanishad* that 'verily there are two kinds of knowledge to be acquired namely *apara* and *para*, lower and higher, so say those who know Brahman—the great seers of the *Upanishads*.' Vide. *Mundaka-upanishad* Chapter 1-I-(4).

upon three *Ratnas* or three Jems of Jainism. *Samyag-Carita* or right conduct, *Samyag-Darsana* or right faith and *Samyag-Gnana* or right knowledge and the ethics of Buddha centres round the memorable maxim that 'desire is the cause of pain.' The ethics of Buddha¹⁰⁷ is however based upon moral intuition, unlike the Utilitarian ethics which is based on social eudaemonia. The intellectual love of God is the minds' highest good said Spinoza¹⁰⁸ the Jewish Philo-

107. The ethics of Buddha is a-typical in its significance. It is conveyed through four noble truths and eight-fold-path. That the world is full of suffering, that there is the cause of suffering, that there can be the cessation of suffering and that there is the final path to liberation which is further characterised by 8 stages to attain *Nirvana* as Right views, Right resolve, Right speech, Right conduct, Right livelihood, Right effort, Right mindfulness and Right concentration. The principle doctrine of Buddhism is that suffering is inseparable from existence which however results in a philosophy of Cynicism and Pessimism.

108. The ethico-religious motive behind Spinoza's doctrines of philosophy signifies a high sense of morality towards humanity. Virtuous action is rational action and that men relinquish their natural rights in order that all may live in peace form some of the fundamental doctrines of Spinoza. Spinoza's Ethics is both individualistic and universalistic. It is individualistic in the sense that it aims at individual perfection; it is universalistic in the sense it teaches that the highest virtue of the mind is to know God. Man is impelled by his insinct to seek this perfection is the true love of God.

sopher of the 17th century. Coleridge¹⁰⁹ the lake poet of the 18th century preached individual ethics through his natural poetry. Each man had some Angel and some God in him and every soul has much beast and some divine was his main belief. Mahatma Gandhi in the recent past classified some men as men of God and some others as men of devil. The current tendency in individual ethics of Sarvodaya on the other hand never embodies the bad in the good nature of Man. Nevertheless it tends to evolve a code of conduct, based on the ancient wisdom of the Jaina philosophy. Sarvodaya advocates five cardinal truths for self-purity of the individuals. *Satyam, Asteyam, Ahimsa, Brahmacharya* and *Aparigraha*. The ends according to Sarvodaya are in means. Thus, moral law in Sarvodaya is unconditional law, the Categorical Imperative. The rigorism of Kantian idealism is however neutralised by releasing the positive and altruistic forces of human sympathy. The scope for voluntary self-acceptance of moral law is more than its inexorable, unconditional and extraneous imposi-

109. Coleridge a friend and associate of William Wordsworth was a leading English poet of the 18th century. He translated Schiller's *Wallenstein* into English from German. He settled in Lake District and published his *Lyrical Ballads* in collaboration with Wordsworth. Coleridge and Wordsworth are together called as Lake poets. Their deep love of Nature characterised the English romantic movements. The Ethics of Samuel Taylor Coleridge was organismic and naturalistic. That man is the hiatus of both egoistic and altruistic impulses, righteous and wicked, good and bad. Thus, instinctive impulse and intuitive self are throughout viewed as co-eternal realities.

tion. When we compare the ethical system of Sarvodaya¹¹⁰ with several other ethical systems of the past we tend to conclude in the light of our above discussion that it is neither intuitionistic nor metaphysical in its application but on the other hand it can be easily categorised under naturalistic ethics. Thus, the ethos of the people should reflect the ethics of Sarvodaya in this age of Crisis particularly when the whole world is placed at the cross-roads of construction and destruction, amelioration and annihilation, war and peace.

110. The ethical doctrines of Sarvodaya run parallel to several other ethical systems of the past as Jaina and Buddha. The ethics of Sarvodaya unlike other systems is naturalistic, humanistic and altruistic. Man is considered as the apex of hierarchy of all splendour of God. He is the emblem of Creation, an embodiment of Virtue and a symbol of Truth, Beauty and Goodness on earth. The extra-pragmatic tendency of Gandhian Idealistic Ethics, the extreme rigoristic outlook of Kantian or formalistic Ethics and the utmost mechanistic tendency of Marxian Ethics of determinism all tend to resolve in Sarvodaya Ethics of human morality. Thus, the ethics of Sarvodaya is based much upon the ethos of the people rather than their social sanctions.

CHAPTER VI

THE RELIGIOUS ASPECT OF SARVODAYA

The religious aspect of Sarvodaya circumscribes around the central reality *Tattvam asi*¹¹¹ i.e., *That art thou*. *Bhakti* based on *manusmṛti* is the ideal content of Sarvodaya religion. *Bhakti* is not a mental state. It is an emotional attachment and an ecstatic expression of self. Self-will and Activity is the essential element of Sarvodaya religious consciousness. For, Vinoba, religion is not a sightless subscription to traditional dogmas or heedless conformity to

111. There are two main traditional and essential doctrines of Upanishads. (1) *Aham Brahmasmi* i.e., I am Brahman, (2) *Tatvam asi* or That Thou Art. This is however treated as advaitic interpretation of the world of reality. The concept *Tatvam asi* is one long discussion between identity and distinction. The ego and the qualified Brahman are one and the same in the absolute sense, as one ego *jiva* is never separate literally from the other ego. The essence of Man and the world principle are ultimately identical. *Madhava* explains Upanishadic statement the identity of essence as identity of resemblance. The souls are of three classes, 'those that are bound but may become free, those that are confined eternally to migration from one life to another within the mundane sphere and those that are doomed permanently to the misery of hell'—'That' is God as the entire universe as one body and 'Thou' is the individual soul as the above body. Vide. Hirayanna *Essentials of Indian Philosophy* P. 192.

Pristine and ancient Rituals. It is above-all an abiding and a living faith in the three Cardinal values of *Truth, Love and Justice*.¹¹² As Gandhian religion was one persistent endeavour to attain a higher life in this world itself, so the living trend of Sarvodaya religion tends to materialise a higher life of angelic righteousness¹¹³ in this world of in-

112. Sarvodaya envisages a philosophy of values. Truth is considered as an intellectual value, Beauty, as aesthetic value and Goodness as moral value. Truth is both eternal and universal concept in Sarvodaya. It is by treading over the path of Truth many a great man of the past have succeeded in their life-ambitions. Our salutations are wholly meant for the holy men of Vedas and adoration to the immortal saints and sages of posterity. "Truth alone wins not untruth. By truth is laid but the path divine along which the seers free from desires ascend to the supreme abode of truth." Vide. *Mundaka-upanishad* Chapter III Sec. 1-5(6).

Ista-sadhana is the realisation of values. A person who is committed to this type of realisation is above all *Preyas* i.e., immediate pleasures. On the other hand he will be a seeker of *Sreyas* i.e., ultimate virtues. In Indian thought, *Truth, Goodness and Beauty* form trinity of values, i.e., *Tri-varga*. For the purposes of common study, values are classified and also graded as physical values, economic values and psychical values; intrinsic and extrinsic values, subjective and objective values, relative and absolute values etc.

113. The ideal of sarvodaya *religious consciousness* is angelic righteousness. The elements of religious consciousness in sarvodaya differ widely from the religious practices of the traditional religions. Religious consciousness implies a free enquiry into religious reality, God, Soul, Immortality, Sin, Salvation

creasing insecurity. *Samnyasa* is neither total renunciation of the world nor it is total cessation of all activity. Renunciation in *Sarvodaya* means the absence of hankering after fruit of action and not indifference to its results—*Karma-Phala-Tyaga*.¹¹⁴

and the Sacred. Rationalistic philosophers like Hegel and Neo-Hegelians maintained that the nature of religious consciousness is prone towards thought and reason than feeling and will. Kant the metaphysical idealist and Fichte the German idealist philosopher considered reason and will as the basis of religious consciousness. Again, Otto and Leuba viewed feeling and faith as the spirit of religious consciousness. On the other hand the semetic religions considered the cult of sacrifice and prayer as the content of religious consciousness. It is thus concluded that religious consciousness is both a process of divination and revelation. That religion which alone is contrary to our nature, in our present estate which declares war against all our pleasures and inclinations and which upon a slight and transient view, seems repugnant even to common sense, is that alone which has subsisted from the beginning. From Pascal's *Thoughts on Religion*.

114. *Karma* is explained as unmitigated law of retribution determining the nature of incarnation. *Karma* is classified variously. *Anarabdha-Karma* and *Arabdha-Karma*. Those actions which have not yet begun to bear fruits are classed as *Anarabdha-karma* and those actions which have begun to bear fruits are explained under *Arabdha-karma*. *Arabdha-karma* is also called popularly as *Prarabdha-karma*. *Anarabdha-karma* is further classified as *Sancita-karma* i.e., whose fruits of action accumulated from past lives and *Sanciya-mana-karma* i.e., whose fruits are being gathered in this life itself. The ethical teachings of 'Upanishads' indicate a new classification of *karma* i.e. *Nitya-karmas* or obligatory deeds, and *kamyakarma's*

Innumerable philosophers of the past interpreted religion in a variety of ways. Religion according, to Hegel¹¹⁵ is a form of representative knowledge. Kantian religion¹¹⁶

or optional deeds. It is here the shifting of emphasis from *kamyā-karmas* to *nitya-karmas* is signified as *Varnasrama-dharma*. As law, *karma* is treated as identical with physical causation or causality. 'Jainas' enumerate 148 *Karmas*. A man who has exhausted all but a remainder of *Prarabdha-karma* and has not accumulated any new *Karma* in his present life is one who is bound to attain salvation while in his present life itself, i.e., *Jivan-mukta*. If one is free from the cycle of life, his life is also invariably free from entering into any other corporeal body for its physical existence, i.e. *Videha-mukta*. Vide. *Kathopanishad Adhyatma-yoga* 5-(4).

115. According to Hegel religion is a pattern or form of knowledge and the object of such a pattern of knowledge is the knowledge of the *Absolute*. It is a symbolic experience; it is the inward exaltation of the soul and the absolute spirit. Hegel was the dominant metaphysical Idealist philosopher of the 18th century.

116. Kantian religion is the religion of the categories; an extra-domain of human activity. Kantian religion is based upon absolute morality. Moral *ought* is unconditional and the religious consciousness is the spontaneous outcome of this moral *ought*. Religion is thus characterised as the fulfilment of morality. Immanuel Kant was a radical moral philosopher of Germany and a transcendental thinker of his age who lived in 18th century.

is a fulfilment of morality; Otto¹¹⁷ expressed that religion is an experience *Sui-generis*. According to Fries¹¹⁸ religion is divination which is 'AHUNDUNG'; Leuba¹¹⁹ calls it as an absorption in the divine Substance. Religion in James¹²⁰ opinion is based on mystical consciousness and so

117. The religion of Rudolf Otto is an emotional attitude. It consists of an emotional *awe* which is a compound feeling of reverence and fear. The *mysterium tremendum* characterised by a process of *divination* is the product of *numinous experience*. Thus, Otto's views on religion acted as counterblast to the Kantian over-emphasis of the moral aspect of religion. Prof. Otto was a prominent German theologian and philosopher of the recent past who died at Marburg in 1937.

118. Jacob Fries was an eminent German philosopher of the later 18th century. That the principle of reason is immediately known through consciousness and that the super-sensible and the *things-in-themselves* are not known to our reason, and that we divinise or surmise the infinite in the finite in religion are some of the main attributes of Fries religious consciousness. Religion is *Ahundung* or divination.

119. Leuba distinguish two religious attitudes. One is revealed through divine transactions with God and the other consists in holy communion with God. Leuba is a noted religious thinker of the modern period.

120. Theism according to James is the only conception of God. Both the emotional and volitional nature of man is satisfied with theistic consciousness. The *will to believe* is the essential faith with James. James is a noted exponent of pragmatism in modern times.

it is only pursued in solitude. Frank¹²¹ asserted on ethico-religious consciousness and Caird¹²² pleaded for the elevation of human spirit into union with the Divine through his religious ideal. Stoical¹²³ view of religion is in the nature of Pantheism. From God all beings proceed and to Him all return at last. The incarnation of God in man forms the core of all Christian¹²⁴ religious consciousness. In the

121. The religious consciousness according to Frank is the principle force of history. Ethico-religious consciousness is the content of Frank's religious attitude. Frank has been influenced avowedly by Mach particularly in the later part of 18th century in America.

122. According to Caird religion is exclusively a matter of feeling not understanding. The seat of religious consciousness is the emotional nature of man. Caird is considered as creative exponent of religious thought in contemporary period. 'Religion is the *alter-ego* of man' says Caird.

123. Stoical religious consciousness believes that nature and God are identical realities. In fact from God all beings proceed and to God all beings return. The Stoic conception of the world is opposed to all forms of egoistic and hedonistic trends. Stoicism was a school founded by Zeno at Athens around 300 B. C.

124. Christian religious consciousness not only believes in the incarnation of God in man but in the reconciliation of man with God through God-man. Christian religious consciousness is in a way based upon some psychological motives of divine dread and fear. Christianity is considered today as one of the major religions of the world.

recent years Arnold J. Toynbe¹²⁵ in his 'Historians approach to religion' very well signified the course of higher religions. Higher religions have uniform and universal codes and beliefs which tend to unite mankind on all levels of existence. Albert Schweitzer¹²⁶ the great altruist of the present age

125. Arnold J. Toynbe is a contemporary British historian of world eminence who very well depicted the fall of Lucifer due to his egoistic error of self-centeredness. All higher religions according to Toynbe have identical objects of worship. They are independent of all narrow considerations of self-centeredness. Sarvodaya religious consciousness signifies a higher code of Ethical Conduct on the part of the individuals.

126. Albert Schwieter, a contemporary altruist of the West who decided to make his life fit his thought preached a humanistic philosophy of *reverence for life* and the respect for the individual. The surmisings and the longings of all deep religiousness are contained in the Ethics of his reverence for life i.e. *Veneratio Vitae*. He is significantly considered as a modern Messiah with a new message to mankind. Schweitzer has created thousands of admirers all over the world. Like Goethe he possesses an inexhaustible passion for knowledge. His life as an altruist has been one long benefaction. He carried the world view i.e., *Weltan-schauung* of Reverence for life. He based his ideas on non-violence. He rejected the self-regarding ideals of man. That life is full of meaning, that world is worth-knowing and that the world-view is the product of life-view characterise his basic teachings. The most important works of Schweitzer are 'Civilization and Ethics,' 'Decay and Restoration of Civilization,' 'On the edge of Primeval forest' and 'Indian thought and its development' etc. According to Schweitzer, the whole history of human civilization is a struggle towards an ethical and altruistic outlook

advocated the ideal of *reverence for life* through his religion. 'Religion is to morality what water is to the seed that is sown in the soil,' said Mahatma Gandhi. Marxian¹²⁷ religion is the opiate of the masses, for the masses.

The rich wealth of variety of religious consciousness is embodied in *Bhagvadgita*, the *Shad-darsanas*¹²⁸ and in *Advaita Vedanta* in India. Religion is something which must be experienced and not defined in India. It is the intuitive love of God. The basic teachings of other major faiths¹²⁹ by which men live—Confucianism, Taoism, Islam

on life. In the absence of such an outlook the world civilization as it is decays. Dr. Schweitzer ultimately tends to build a positive philosophy of his own based on the principle of life and world-affirmation.

127. The religion of Marx is one long contradiction to the traditional conception of higher religions. That material conditions determine the human consciousness has conditioned Marxian religious consciousness to such a degree that religion is reduced to the opiate of the masses and to the affair of the few. Karl Marx's revolutionary views which appeared in his treatise *Das Capital* were later on completed by Engels. Marx widely dominated the world thought with his ideas in the later 17th and the early 18th centuries.

128. *Sad-darsanas* are six systems of Indian philosophy which are recognised as orthodox schools and fall in line with vedic traditions. *Nyaya*, *Vaisesika*, *Samkhya*, *Yoga*, *Mimamsa*, and *Vedanta* are considered as *Sad-darsanas*. Indian philosophy is a unity in diversity.

129. Hinduism, Buddhism, Christianity, Islam, Zoroastrianism, Confucianism, Taoism and Judaism are traditionally considered as major faiths. Sarvodaya envisages an essential unity among all religions.

and Judaism etc., also indicated high religious beliefs based on intuitive love of God and His greatness. Indian idealism advocates a new religious revival through Sarvodaya. This new religious revival can alone save the world from utter annihilation and wholesome destruction. Sarvodaya teaches a dynamic religion based both on human morality and as well as spiritual morality. Sarvodaya pleads for a unifying force among the present religions of the world nations. Sarvodaya is against any form of state-imposed religious consciousness. Sarvodaya prayer¹³⁰ is a longing of the soul, a medium of self-purification. Sarvodaya takes interest in the self of all mankind through its inviolable spirit of self-surrender based on self-realisation.

Sarvodaya religious consciousness tends to satisfy all the needs of a Natural religion. That there is one God; that He ought to be worshipped; that worship consists of piety and sympathy; that we must reform our actions and that we should surrender our means and ends to the welfare of all form the main attributes of Sarvodaya religious consciousness.

130. The Sarvodaya prayer is a form of *Mantra-yog*. It is mainly meant to apply our consciousness, that is, *Niyama* to all the eleven *Sampattis* or virtues. It involves both *Para-bhakti* and *Apara-bhakti*. After the acquisition and assimilation of all the above principles, a *Sarvodayi* becomes an *Adhikari* who is capable of some *Sadhanas*. Non-violence, Truth, Non-stealing, Non-indulgence, Manual labour, Non-possession, Non-hoarding, Absolute fearlessness, Oneness of all creeds *dharma*s i.e. absolute devotion to nation and abounding humility, may all these eleven principles be within me—*Sarvodaya prayer*.

St. Francis was one of the greatest lovers of God and also one of the greatest lovers of men. He was an ardent disciple of Jesus. He travelled extensively to redress the grievances of the people and thus alleviate their suffering. Similarly Acharya Vinoba Bhave is both a lover of God and a lover of men. Again as a true disciple of Gandhi he travelled extensively to meet the ailing humanity in accordance with the duty expected of him i.e., *Kartavya-Karma*. Vinoba exists in-and-through society. He lays his individual being in this world as well as in the other world. He has an existential communion with other men as much as his inspirational contact with the Spirit. Vinoba is tending to preach the ideal of Universal benevolence to the human race in general. His philosophy can be categorised under Social Altruism in modern times. *Jai-Jagat*¹³¹ or the welfare of the whole world has become the Manual of Ethics of Acharya in these days. Quite recently he gave generic slogan *Jai-Jago* to the people. *Jnana-Karma-Samvaccaya*¹³² is the *summum bonum* of his integral philosophy. He is purifying knowledge with action and reforming action with

131. The triumph of the world or *Jai-Jagat* is the slogan of Sarvodaya. It implies the total-well-being of man and uplift of his race throughout the world. Quite recently Vinoba gave a new slogan of *Jai-Jagao* or the triumph of consciousness to the people during his visit to Pakistan. *Jai-Jagat* and *Jai-Jagao* are one of the major generic slogans of Sarvodaya.

132. The integration of action with knowledge and knowledge with action is the *summum-bonum* of Sarvodaya Ethical philosophy. The adoration and glorification of action with knowledge is as much necessary as veneration and the purification of knowledge through action. *Siddhiyog* of sarvodaya is a synthesis of both *Jnanayoga* and *Karmayoga*.

knowledge in more than one way. Acharya Vinoba Bhave as an agrarian reformer of the first rank has successfully introduced an element of voluntarism in capitalism, through his creative ideals of *Bhoodan*. Thus, Sarvodaya is felt as a perennial philosophy and Acharya is viewed as an Alchemist of world character in modern times. Acharya again is no less than a sage who by his implicit faith and selfless action became one with his mission. An invulnerable Knight fighting with magic armour was said of Gandhi by Dean Inge in the past. Acharya Bhave has got into the place of Gandhi in this respect. Acharya Bhave like Cardinal Newman is a great missionary by nature and again like Marcus Aurelius¹³³ he is imbued with a dynamic ideal of world unity. His followers are spread like the noble knights of King Arthur throughout the nation, nay even throughout the world working sincerely towards the cause of Sarvodaya giving a bold fight to *Avidya-Kama-Karma*¹³⁴. The religion of Sarvodaya is thus the religion of the whole world.

133. Marcus Aurelius Antonineus, the Roman emperor of the 2nd century was a great religious philosopher. He was the author of 12 books of *Meditations* in Greek. He was much influenced by Stoical thought. His religious consciousness was both stoical and skeptical and so atypical. Similar tendencies of thought can, however, be discovered in our ancient religious texts. "He who knows at the same time both Vidya and Avidya overcomes death by Avidya and obtains immortality by Vidya" vide. *Isa-Upanishad* Chapter XI-(12).

134. The *avidya-kama-karma* or ignorance as the by-product of action based on desire is the main impediment to sarvodaya realisation. Therefore one

CONCLUSION

Sarvodaya is a well-integrated social and moral philosophy. It is however considered as a recent tendency particularly in social philosophy. Sarvodaya is a new movement towards life. It is a synthetic ideology and a universal concept. It is indeed an improvement over all forms of creative altruism¹³⁵ and evolutionary humanism.¹³⁶ Its communitarian outlook draws it nearer to Social Univer-

who has renounced all desires is considered as the most blessed-being. 'A hundred-fold bliss of Indra, the King of Gods, is the unit of joy of Brihaspati, the teacher of Gods; this Bliss is also equal to the Bliss of a *Shrotriya*, who is devoid of all desires. Vide *Taittiriya-Upanishad Brahmananda Valli* Chapter III. Similar ideas associated with *Avidya-Kama-Karma* can be traced to *Mundaka-upanishad* as 'Let an aspirant after he has examined the worlds gained by Karma acquire freedom from all desires reflecting that nothing that is eternal can be gained by Karma.' Vide. *Mundaka-Upanishad* Chapter I Section 2 V-(12).

135. Pitrim A. Sorokin, one of the most powerful thinkers of the contemporary world, pleads for control of *overt-behaviours* among various social communities. This is a positive check over one's bad actions. He goes ahead of this and preaches an *altruistic ethical conduct* on the lines of Cicero and Aristotle. He pleads for the overall elimination of *sensate values* and suggests thereby some adequate means towards inculcating certain fundamental *moral values* and thus enrich the super-organic powers of modern man by all means. This is commonly called as *Creative Altruism* in the West.

136. Julian Huxley, the world famous contemporary American biologist started a new trend in Humanism called *evolutionary humanism*. The inviolable impact of modern biology on social dynamics has

salism. The essential doctrines of Sarvodaya are however superior to the doctrines of some of the significant social theories both old and new. The social theories preached by Totalitarian Communism, Democratic Socialism and Parliamentary Democracy seemed to have failed in bringing about the desired social integration. Sarvodaya, on the other hand as an evolutionary social concept seems to have succeeded to a certain extent in establishing a social cohesion at least on ideological levels of human consciousness in modern times. *Loka-yatika* doctrines of Carvaka attempted to achieve lower carnal integration in the past. The Mahayana teachings of Buddhism aimed at a greater and higher unification of mankind through its most generic ideal of *Bodhisattva* in the 6th century B.C. Ashoka the spirited ruler of India in the succeeding ages has attempted to unite the world through his noble attitude towards life. Conversion and not coercion, revulsion and not revocation was the main motto of his moral ambition. In modern times Gandhi and Vinoba have turned the course of human history towards new vistas of human evolution. Many a Prophet and preacher of the past have invariably attempted to establish general human integration in their own periods. For example, Marx aimed at material integration of mankind; Rousseau opted for social integration; Buddha aspired for an ethical integration of mankind; Asoka endeavoured for moral integration and quite recently Aurobindo inspi-

caused for the creation of certain social and human norms & standards in modern times, which however tend to glorify the intrinsic personality of modern man. It is universally believed that human psyche from occasion to occasion is evolving new phases of consciousness. The evolution of such new levels of consciousness is indicative of man's high aspiration.

ringly designed for a spiritual integration of mankind. On the other hand Acharya Vinoba Bhave in the contemporary period seems to have overwhelmingly engaged in bringing about the *total human integration*¹³⁷ from all angles and aspects for the present race of mankind. Nonetheless, on one plane he is the true embodiment of human race itself; an embodiment which embraces the total and integral well-being of man in modern times—ADIEU.

137. Sarvodaya exploits all human resources and employs them towards greater integration and harmonisation. Sarvodaya transformation is indeed considered as an all-sided total integration i.e., *Samagra-Samanvaya*. In view of our study, we can say that Sarvodaya envisages a *Yoga* i.e., *Siddhiyog* which is nearer to *Niyama* of *Ashtayog*, *Yama* of *Raj-yog*, *Tulya-Avashtha* of the *Yoga* of *Yog-Vashishta* and the *Samatva-Yoga* of the *Yoga* of 'Bhagvad-Gita'. *Niyam* is adjustment with Society, *Yama* is universal equality, *Tulya-avashtha* indicates an act which involves the realisation of the ideal in actual and *Samatva-Yoga* is the 'Yoga' of equanimity. This 'Yoga' of equanimity or poise has assumed two forms in 'Bhagwad-Gita,' that is, (1) *Samatva-Yoga-Uchyate*, (2) *Yoga-Karmasu-Kaushalam*. Thus, in recent years some new interpretations of 'Yoga' have come up as *Prapatti-Yoga* of Sri Aurobindo, *Anasakti-Yoga* of Mahatma Gandhi and *Siddhiyog* of Acharya Vinoba Bhave.

APPENDICES

1

The Sarvodaya ideal of universal betterment and One-World-Order with its all-comprehensive concept of *Samya-Yoga* has arborised the entire body politic of the World Nations in these days. The Sarvodaya concept of *Dharma*, its creative ideal of *Rita* as the universal moral order pervading the scheme of events and happenings form an essential feature of its Integralisation of Social Order. Besides, the evolution of its original ideal of *Janashakti* as the Third force in the new Evolutionary Social Order further reveals the other essential attributes of Sarvodaya philosophy.

2

The philosophy of history both in the East and the West has witnessed innumerable social upheavals from time immemorial. The historic contribution of revolutions and counter-revolutions in the ancient period and the contributions made by the Reform Movements of the mediaeval period and their subsequent creative synthetic culmination in the Age of Renaissance is indeed a boon to social history. Again, the egalitarian Ideals of *Social Realism* of the recent past, their generic revival in Sarvodaya and the current-day integrated social philosophy has been considered by one-and-all as the apex of social realisation in modern times. However, the spiritualisation of Social Ideals is not an altogether new legacy; St. Francis and St. Augustine in the early phase of human history, Gautama Buddha and Ashoka in the succeeding ages and quite recently the realistic writings of Leo Tolstoy and Oswald Spengler were successful in effecting higher human and social transformations.

Each one of them have tried their inherited talents to bring about radical social changes. The Spiritualisation of Social Order was their common ultimate motto. This process of Spiritualisation embraces all other social ideals of economic reconstruction and social transformation. Once again we visually witness in the current-day world ideology this integral social philosophy of human realisation and social emancipation in the generic ideals of Sarvodaya.

3

Irrespective of some of the present-day baseless and valueless criticisms of some of the deterministic, idle dreamers we tend to accept and embrace Sarvodaya philosophy as the only solution to human fulfilment and world betterment, apart from its day-to-day attributes of economic and social contributions. The universal appeal of Sarvodaya and its Integrated Social Ideal in the current-day contemporary thought is both a living and a growing challenge to all deterministic ideals of Marxian Communism, conservative concepts of Fabian socialism, and the unweildy characteristic ideals of Parliamentary democracy.

4

It is generally considered by the majority of the followers of Sarvodaya that to have a broad-based perspective of the present-day local, national and international problems that are currently occupying extensive areas of human talent are absorbing much of human potentialities have little or no significance in the broader context of Sarvodaya ideals. This one-sided partial view is indeed considered as a harmful sign by the ever-evolving intelligentsia of Sarvodaya Movement, more particularly in this age of rapid scientific advancement and ever-growing mechanisation.

The vital issues which attract our imagination on a wider level of community living and social understanding are in the nature of World-Peace, Disarmament of Nations, One-World-Order, and Unification of social ideologies etc., in this age of social crisis. The generic idea of *Shanti-sena* as envisaged by Sarvodaya has indeed done a yeoman service to World Peace and Human Survival. However, the current-day political problems that are besetting our great nation in this age of action and inter-action like the Kashmir issue, Indo-China and other border disputes, the problem of Naga-land, linguistic troubles, river-water quarrels, etc., need proper attention of the idealistic thinkers of the Sarvodaya Samaj in order to resolve the day-to-day dy-hard social and political tensions. Among the varied other national reconstruction movemests of the recent past which have been readily inspired by the creative ideals of the Sarvodaya philosophy are in the nature of Democratic de-centralisation, as the significant contribution to moders democracy and National Integration. This is a new addition to the existing social and national goals and ideals during the last few years.

5

The social dialectics of Marx included a bio-physical inter-action i.e., material wealth and human consciousness and evolved a positive philosophy of dialectical or historical materialism. On the other hand the social dynamics of Maharshi Vinoba Bhave characterises a three-sided social inter-action i.e., Material wealth, Human Consciousness and Social Good and evolve an altruistic synthetic social philosophy of Sarvodaya. Thus, the Economics of Sarvodaya is not based upon simple social dialectics but it is based upon a complex social mechanism and dynamics which is

indeed an improvement over all other basic economic doctrines preached and practised by Vedic, Buddhistic, Christian Social Prophets, Sages and Saints. The social dynamics of Sarvodaya treats Bhoodan as a historical necessity in the process of social evolution and not as a mere social philanthropic gift.

6

Whether the social ideal of Bhoodan serves as a contradiction to social legislation in its over-emphasis on social good and objective reason to the exclusion of individual good and personal realisation is a problem before the present-day thinkers of social ideology. The utilitarian concept of Bentham i.e., the greatest good of the greatest numbers and the universal ideal of Buddha i.e., the liberation of the Sentient beings of the world and the generic ideal of Sarvodaya Samaj, i.e., the general and total welfare of the people involve higher ideals of Social Realism, Positive humanism and Creative altruism. The extensive mechanisation, the heavy industrialisation and the rapid scientific advancement have however contributed largely towards *de-humanisation* in modern society. The need for an ideal renovation of the original milk of human kindness in humanity in-general and the need for a *search of Man in man* in particular through the creative ideals of Sarvodaya Samaj is indeed considered altogether as a new contribution towards individual good and social transformation. The educative ideals of the creative ideology of Sarvodaya envisage a new movement in the socio-economic field of man. The control in prices of necessary goods and essential commodities to raise the general standards of community living, proper utilisation and economy of leisure, good treatment of the *Sahayak* etc.,

render a clue to the new evolutionary social philosophy of Sarvodaya in India. In this aspect the supra-conscious basis of Sarvodaya Ideology supersedes the ethico-moral ideal of creative altruism of the West.

7

Sarvodaya Ideology thus implies an integration and re-integration of human virtues on one hand and assertion and re-assertion of human values on the other in its synthetic and dynamic sweep over all other ulterior human motives based on selfish action of human progress. The social existence is not a product of contractual social inter-action but it is the outcome of altruistic social relationship. So Sarvodaya Ideology envisages at-once a new philosophy based both on the *altruisation* of man on one hand and the *transfiguration* of society on the other. This intrinsic truth is however very well delineated by one of the leading modern writes of literary renaissance, Aldous Huxley who contends that no human species can transcend itself individually and sporadically without its entirety in terms of humanity. This characteristic human and social truth is indeed present in all forms of socio-religious philosophies i.e., Taoism, Buddhism, Confucianism and Christianity. The affirmation of social living and the emphasis on reverence for the individual-life go hand-in-glove in Sarvodaya Ideal of Social co-existence. This is both a life-view and a world-view juxtaposed, harmonised and well-integrated into one collective stream of human and social consciousness and which serves as a clue to wider realisation, greater harmonisation and higher aspiration in modern times.

8

If the Sarvodaya workers and the idealistic social thinkers rising above the customary traditions wilfully tend to

concentrate on some of the important social problems of local origin like Corruption, Exploitation, Unemployment and Adulteration, much of the existing social maladies can be eliminated in modern times. If Sarvodaya workers as *Bodhisattvas* of Mahayana Buddhism, *Jains* of Jainism and as noble and valiant *knights* of King Arthur's Round Table set-out to work in a wider sphere of community life and social understanding the days are not far off when we witness the creative and altruistic ideals of our Sant Vinoba multiplying, spreading and arborising the content of community life to bring about a radical social transformation in this age of great crisis.

9

Further again, if some potential workers of sincerity and integrity of Sarvodaya tend to organise some mass campaigns and mass movements and wilfully assist the national policies of our great Nation in fixing the creative and useful ideals of prohibition, co-operation and collective farming, community uplift, social education etc., sudden and revolutionary changes on all levels of human activity can be brought towards a higher community life of greater co-operation and better understanding. The active participation much above the average standards of formal co-operation of the common man of the Panchayat Raj in the great and gigantic task of community building, village planning and local industry can constitute unconditionally towards the social dynamics of Sarvodaya Movement.

10

The broad-based and all-comprehensive Sarvodaya Samaj on this auspicious occasion of ideological confluence and convergence of the people from various parts of our

great country tend to give a constructive plan for the workers not only on the basis of the man-made self-evaluated paper plans, but on the basis of God-given self-impelled divine plans based on human endeavour, social reason and spiritual ideal right through the medium of many a sincere worker, who are no-doubt selfless, and egoless devotees of the great cause—the cause of Universal Good.

11

I, personally, feel on such an occasion as this that the workers of our Samaj should emphasize hereafter more upon the behavioural than ideological social identifications in order to bring-about a creative and an effective social transformation on practical than theoretical plans of social and collective action. If the Sarvodaya workers still linger from doing hard work and shirk their natural responsibilities towards their brethren who form a major section of community living, all the theoretical considerations of such provincial conferences will be of no avail and the Sarvodaya Ideology and its shaping into a concrete, creative ideal will be as much as building castles in the air and constructing shrines on the grain of sand—JAI JAGAT*

**(Selections from the Presidential Address of Shri V. Ramachandra Reddy, of Pochampalli, to the Fourth Andhra Pradesh Sarvodaya Sammelan held at Vizayawada April 1962).*

POST SCRIPT

NEW TRENDS IN SARVODAYA

1

The chief doctrines of Sarvodaya characterise the absolute nature of Sarvodaya Samaj. The greatest good of all, the ends are in means, rights follow the duties are some of the most popular doctrines. That the goal of life ever-recedes from us; that the consecrated hard work forms the *Summum bonum* of life and that the realisation of ultimate values of life which form the central core of Gandhian Ideology are also treated as one of the most salient attributes of Sarvodaya. Among the *Yamas* or the practice of don'ts we can include such sayings as hate the sin and not the sinner and do not venture to entertain any illusions. This can be possible only when we develop selfless and purposive behaviours based on direct experience i.e., *Pratyaksha-Bhavana*.

2

The Sarvodaya Ideology presents multiple dimensions. The economic, social, moral, ethical and religious aspects have already been discussed in detail. All these varied aspects of this integrated social philosophy however aim at the same *anubhuti* or consciousness. This consciousness is the consciousness of *Dharma*. A Sarvodayi abhors *para-dharma* as much as *A-dharma*. Para-dharma is others virtue and A-dharma is non-virtue.

3

In *Samyayoga society* of Sarvodaya the individual presents a social dynamics. The group of individuals is not

the mere summation of the individuals. It represents the integral whole instead of sum-total. Individual is a part *amsa* and the society is the whole *amsin*. Thus, the dignity of man is considerably raised in Sarvodaya society. Again in the ideal state of Sarvodaya the rule of the ruled is more important than the rule of the ruler.

4

The communitarian ideals contained in Sarvodaya are note-worthy. However a feeling of one-ness and a feeling of friendliness i.e., *Eki-bhavana* and *Mitra-bhavana* runs through them all. From *Gramodyog* the communitarian ideals reached a stage called *Gram-bhavana* i.e., village feeling. These ideals have earlier undergone the popular stages of *Gram-sabha*, *Gram-raj* and *Gram-panchayat*. Communitarianism is not identical with Socialism. Socialism is more or less a science of society whereas Sarvodaya is an ideal which always remains an ideal to be persued by man in society. This does not mean that it is an impractical ideal like the ideal state of plato. On the other hand it is an ever-evolving ideal of human consciousness i.e., *anubhuti*. Again *Sarvodaya-vada* is neither *svabhava-vada*, naturalism or *animitta-vada* or accidentalism. It is *Bhavaniti-vada* governed by the laws of one's own feeling based on Dharma or Virtue.

5

There is a remarkable difference between Sarvodaya the integrated social philosophy and other inconsistent social ideologies like Marxian communism, Fabian socialism and other forms of Parliamentary democracy. Sarvodaya is not devoid of *manava-bhavana* i.e., the feeling that man is the

central core of all reality. So, it aims invariably at the realisation of human ends or *purushartha* together with *Isvaratha* or the ideal of God-realisation. *Artha* and *Kama* are very well balanced with *Dharma* and *Moksha*. *Sarvodaya* embodies in itself the concept of co-existence of all social ideologies i.e., *Sarva-darsana-sangraha*. Thus, *Sarvodaya-darsana* is a perfect philosophy which tends to balance very well both *life-view* and *world-view* in one harmonious reality.

6

Modern civilization is bereft of any real content. It has neither *life-view* nor *world-view* before it. There has been although rapid atomisation of society with the rapid advancement of science. A hollowness of life has set-in in the affairs of men. The ideals have been reduced to mere wish-fulfilment. Under such circumstances *Sarvodaya* envisages the principle of *Dama* or self-control. *Dama* is characterised as *Yama* or the practice of the don't and *Niyama* is a positive belief in the practice of the good. In no way these controls will inhibit the intrinsic nature of man. On the other hand they contribute largely though directly or indirectly to the cultural progress of man i.e., to his *nagarika-vritti*. *Sarvodaya* is thus a philosophy of social culture as much as it is a philosophy of self-control.

7

Welfare and warfare are not incompatibles in *Sarvodaya*. On the other hand they can co-exist without any friction. *Sarvodayis* are no less *Paursha-vadins*. The determined effort of *Sarvodaya* workers is the outcome of their will to do good. They are idealists of the extreme type. So very

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often their quest is only for something *quiet*. Contentment and tranquility are the watchwords of Sarvodaya workers. In fact the real aim of *Sarvodaya-vadians* is to attain *Karma-Samadhi*. The realisation of action by identifying atman with action, is called *Karma-Samadhi*. Thus, *San-khya* or theory is balanced with *Yoga* or Practice. *Yoga* is a form of *Sastra* whereas *Sankhya* is a form of *Kala*.

8

In the recent past with the declaration of emergency in our country Sarvodayis were divided on the ideal of non-violence. Some believed in the principle of *Sakti-Nirbandha* i.e., power or force which is unfettered. In their final analysis all of them believed in one Sakti as *Vidhi* or command. When Sakti is employed on the principle of *Lobha* or greed it is not only not justified but it becomes invalid and obsolete. But when Sakti is used as a matter of justice or right i.e., *Adhikara* it is both justified and valid. The age which we live in is called *Kali-yuga* i.e., iron age as much as *Satya-yuga* the age of truth and justice. However, right type of militant nationalism is always preferred to aggressive patriotism of the crude type.

9

The implementation of the Kamraj Plan on a national level has created stir among the lovers of democracy in India. It however, speaks of India's dedicated leadership. On more than one occasion Sarvodaya Karyakartas in different states have repeatedly pointed out the evils of pomp and power but there has been an unpardonable slackness on the part of the Government sector for long. Of course, now with the ever-arising artificial challenges of war our nation

has aroused from its dogmatic slumber. The programmes had to be brought nearer to the policies and the power had to step-down the golden stair-case of the Government machinery to meet the commoner in a common way. Under these circumstances if the workers of Sarvodaya learn to use their powers of self-effort i.e., *purusakara* many of the so called evils of individual indolence may be averted. Always a pure ambition is considered almost an achievement.

10

Sarvodaya ideology is considered as a creative blend of all humanistic and altruistic tendencies of the age. It can however be interpreted in terms of an integrated social philosophy in this age of crisis. Its concepts of 'whole man' and 'total reality' are widely acclaimed as the ideal sources of knowledge i.e., *Prama*. Sarvodaya pursuit of reality never separates life-view from the world-view. *Atma-jnana* is as much important as *Loka-dharma*. *Jivatman* i.e., individual consciousness is not separate from *Virad-atman* i.e., Cosmic consciousness. Thus, arises the need to integrate science and spirituality. The secrets of atom are no other than the secrets of *atman* provided we study them with pure imagination i.e., *Shuddha-Sankalpa*. Thus, a new hope awaits man which can be materialised however if we tap his hitherto neglected resources. The real key to peace and progress lies in mobilisation of the most potent and inherent resources i.e., *spiritual resources*. If the latent potentialities of man are somehow made to combine with his inherent spiritual resources there can be no other power left on earth which can stop the march of man towards greater evolution of his being and larger fulfilment of his race.

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